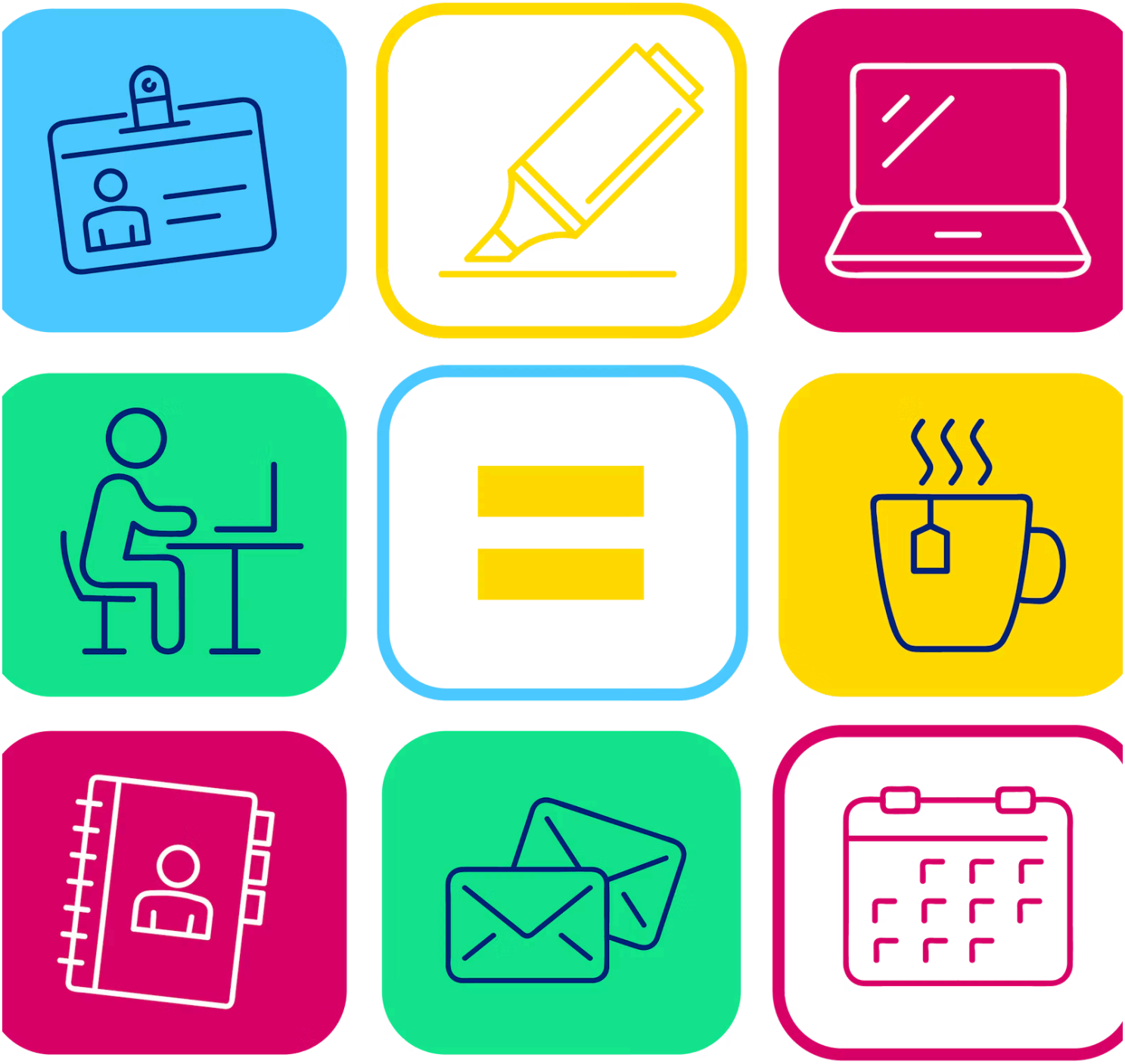
Corporate Equality Index 2025

Rating Workplaces on Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender and Queer Equality

Human Rights Campaign Foundation, January 2025





Message from HRC's President

As we release the 2025 Corporate Equality Index (CEI), I'm mindful that this moment calls for both celebration and clear-eyed recognition of the challenges ahead. For 22 years, the CEI has served as corporate America's roadmap for LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion—not as a political statement, but as a framework for building stronger, more competitive businesses where all talent can thrive.

The numbers in this year's report tell a compelling story: 765 companies, employing over 13 million workers in the United States, are achieving a 100 percent on the CEI -- a 28% increase from last year's report. Additionally, 1,449 major businesses, employing over 22 million Americans, have worked with the HRC Foundation to level the playing field for their LGBTQ+ workers through the CEI. We're seeing continued commitment in corporate America's drive toward inclusion. But behind these statistics are real people, real lives, and real opportunities created.

I've spoken with CEOs and corporate leaders across America who share a fundamental understanding: this work isn't about politics—it's about people. It's about the same-sex couple who no longer has to choose between starting a family and their career. It's about the transgender employee who can now access essential healthcare just like their peers. It's about the young professional who can bring their full self to work, focusing their energy on innovation rather than hiding who they are.

Let me be direct: we understand the complex landscape businesses are navigating. In a time of intense political polarization, companies face pressure from those seeking to undermine non-discrimination protections. Yet the data is unequivocal—inclusive workplaces drive innovation, attract top talent, and deliver better business outcomes. The companies

participating in the CEI understand that workplace equality isn't just a moral imperative; it's a business necessity in an increasingly competitive global marketplace.

The evolution of the CEI reflects this reality. When we first began the CEI, 40 percent of rated companies provided LGBTQ+ employee resource groups alongside other resource groups. Today, 92 percent do. When we introduced criteria in 2009 leveling the healthcare playing field for transgender workers, it was considered groundbreaking. Today, 87% of participating companies offer this coverage, recognizing it as a fundamental part of comprehensive employee healthcare. This progress wasn't achieved through mandates but through businesses recognizing the vital connection between inclusive benefits and workforce wellbeing.

To our corporate partners: we see your commitment to this journey. Whether you're just beginning to implement LGBTQ+-inclusive policies or are among our top-scoring achievers, the CEI is designed to meet you where you are and guide you forward. The tool's endurance over two decades speaks to its practical value in helping businesses build cultures of belonging.

The challenges we face are real, but so are the solutions the CEI provides. As companies navigate complex societal discussions, the CEI remains focused on measurable actions that improve fairness for workers: comprehensive non-discrimination policies, inclusive benefits, equitable healthcare, and cultures where everyone can contribute their best work.

Looking ahead, we remain committed to evolving the CEI to meet emerging needs while maintaining its core focus on tangible impact. The HRC Foundation’s workplace team will also continue its work as a trusted partner with companies across industries. Because ultimately, this isn't about scorecards or rankings—it's about creating workplaces where every person can succeed,

contribute, and thrive. That's not just good values; it's good business.

The path forward requires courage, commitment, and clarity of purpose. We will continue to serve as a partner on this journey. Together, we're building not just better workplaces, but a stronger, more competitive, and more equitable American economy.

KELLEY ROBINSON (SHE/HER/HERS)
President
Human Rights Campaign

In this 22nd edition of the Human Rights Campaign Foundation's Corporate Equality Index, HRC continues advancing inclusive and equitable workplaces.

During this survey cycle, we once again saw state legislators attack our transgender and non-binary community members while extremists opposing LGBTQ+ equality attacked our corporate partners. For decades, businesses have faced such challenges, yet inclusive policies and practices remain a core value and driver of success. Despite these efforts, businesses rose to the challenge and reaffirmed their commitment to maintaining and improving upon their workplace environments to be inclusive of all employees.

The 2025 CEI achieved record participation, with 1,449 companies officially-rated. Among

The CEI helps guide the wide-scale adoption of LGBTQ+ specific practices and language within existing business structures. For example, where businesses enumerate federally protected categories of workers in their non-discrimination policies (e.g. based on race, religion, disability, sex, etc.), the HRC Foundation evaluates them on the inclusion of "sexual orientation" and "gender identity" protections. In terms of benefits, the HRC Foundation evaluates employers on the provision of health insurance coverage for same- and different-sex spouses and domestic partners. In addition, the HRC Foundation assesses the availability of routine, chronic care, and transition-related medical

them, **765** businesses earned 100 points and were recognized as "Equality 100 Award: Leader in LGBTQ+ Workplace Inclusion" awardees. This marks a **28%** increase in businesses earning this designation–in just one year–and reflects the dedication and advocacy of internal champions who make this progress possible. HRC commends all participants for their efforts, knowing that the CEI exists to promote inclusive workplaces for LGBTQ+ employees and all the work businesses do is vital to this community. As businesses adopt the CEI's framework, they underscore their commitment to fostering inclusion and advance the mission for workplace equality.

Top-rated CEI employers come from nearly every industry and region of the United States and represent employers in all 50 states. To earn top ratings, employers took concrete and dedicated steps to establish and implement comprehensive policies, benefits, and practices that ensure greater equity for LGBTQ+ workers and their families. The current CEI rating criteria had four key pillars:

- **Nondiscrimination policies across business entities;**
- **Equitable benefits for LGBTQ+ workers and their families;**
- **Supporting an inclusive culture; and,**
- **Corporate social responsibility.**

Since 2002, the Human Rights Campaign Foundation has published the CEI report based coverage for transgender employees and dependents.

Where major businesses regularly provide education, training, and accountability measures on diversity and inclusion in the workplace, the HRC Foundation seeks to ensure that these systems include the LGBTQ+ workforce. Lastly, major businesses have a range of engagement programs for their target markets and the communities in which they operate, such as advertising, public policy engagement, supplier diversity, philanthropy, and sponsorship. We seek the inclusion of the LGBTQ+ community in these external engagement efforts.

By using the CEI criteria as a roadmap, businesses can help ensure that their existing policy and benefits infrastructure is inclusive of LGBTQ+ workers and their families, resulting in greater recruitment and retention of a talented, diverse workforce. The CEI serves as a guide to LGBTQ+ inclusive policies and practices, but it cannot provide a holistic assessment of the unique workplace cultures and individual experiences that characterize different employers. A CEI rating is one key evaluation metric, among others, in assessing the LGBTQ+ inclusiveness of any employer or provider of goods or services.

In addition to the ongoing commitment of the many prior participants, the 2025 CEI shows a significant growth in the number of newly participating businesses. This year's report contains **72** new businesses from over **35** industries that opted into the survey.

largely on the annual CEI survey administered to hundreds of major global employers. The first Index in 2002 had just 13 companies with a score of 100, in comparison to the 765 companies that, as of this edition, earned this score.

Companies rated in the CEI include Fortune magazine's 500 largest publicly traded businesses (Fortune 500), American Lawyer magazine's top 200 revenue-grossing law firms (AmLaw 200), and hundreds of mid- to large-sized businesses that are publicly- or privately-held.

The following report is reflective of verified data submitted to the HRC Foundation as well as independent research on non-responding businesses. Wherever credit can be verified, all ranked businesses will receive it, irrespective of their participation in the CEI survey.

To date, the HRC Foundation has worked with thousands of businesses to promote workplace equality for LGBTQ+ workers.

Facts about the Corporate Equality Index

First launched in 2002, the HRC Foundation's Corporate Equality Index is the leading roadmap and benchmarking tool for U.S. businesses in the field of workplace equality for lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and queer employees. With over 20 years of impact, the CEI evaluates companies based on four core pillars: non-discrimination protections, equitable benefits, inclusive internal culture, and corporate social responsibility.

Purpose of the CEI

The CEI's main purpose is to create safer, more inclusive and welcoming workplaces for LGBTQ+ individuals. The CEI survey is a benchmarking tool that helps businesses assess their level of LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion by providing a clear, actionable framework. The survey focuses on four key pillars that serve as the framework for the CEI criteria: non-

discrimination policies, equitable healthcare benefits, inclusive internal workplace culture, and corporate social responsibility.

Administration of the CEI

The CEI is administered by the Human Rights Campaign Foundation, a tax-exempt 501(c)(3) organization.

The HRC Foundation envisions a world where all LGBTQ+ people can participate fully in the systems that shape our daily lives. Through public education, research, and policy and practice change, the Foundation's impact can be felt in schools, on factory floors and corporate suites, and in places of worship. It touches LGBTQ+ lives from childhood through end-of-life, people of all races, ethnicities, sexual orientations, gender identities, abilities and religious beliefs, in big cities and small towns, in the United States and across the globe.

As a 501(c)(3) organization, the HRC Foundation does not engage in political or electoral work. It operates independently of any political affiliation, with a commitment to advancing equality through non-partisan initiatives focused on education, research, and collaboration with stakeholders. Both the HRC Foundation and its partner organization, the Human Rights Campaign, are non-partisan advocates for LGBTQ+ inclusion and equality.

Principles of the CEI Criteria

For over twenty years, the CEI has upheld transparent and fair standards, fostering LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion. The HRC Foundation is committed to identifying the best in class policies and practices that improve the experiences of LGBTQ+ employees while providing the resources and consultation necessary for businesses to achieve their

desired scores. These principles of the CEI ensure that the criteria are rigorous, measurable, and adaptable to the diverse needs of participating employers and the LGBTQ+ community.

The CEI's criteria are designed to be rigorous yet fair, incorporating leading and best practices that any mid- to large- size employer can reasonably implement. Recognizing the diversity of U.S. employers, the criteria accommodates a range of industries, from consumer-focused businesses to specialized fields like law and technology. To support businesses in meeting these standards, the Human Rights Campaign Foundation offers templates, guidance, consultation and other resources, making implementation of the CEI criteria accessible and feasible. Additionally, the scoring emphasizes parity rather than preferential treatment, requiring employers to extend equal benefits and protections to LGBTQ+ employees, ensuring fairness without creating undue advantages.

Transparency and objectivity are also cornerstones of the CEI criteria. Every metric is quantitatively measurable, providing clarity and accountability for all participants. The criteria are inclusive of both domestic and global policies, enabling companies to benchmark their efforts consistently across their entire operations, ensuring comparability across industries and years. For LGBTQ+ employees and job seekers, the CEI provides critical transparency by identifying workplaces where they can feel safe, valued, and supported. By publicly rating companies on their LGBTQ+ inclusion efforts, the CEI serves as a reliable resource for understanding which employers have committed to fostering affirming environments. This transparency empowers LGBTQ+ individuals to make informed decisions about where to work and contributes to creating a more equitable workforce overall.

Finally, attainability and reliability anchor the CEI's approach. While new unscored questions and emerging practices are introduced to reflect ongoing developments, the core criteria remain stable for year-to-year comparisons. Furthermore, the HRC Foundation provides at least 2 survey cycles' notice – usually in two year spans, of any

significant changes. This ensures ample time for corporate partners to prepare and adapt. This thoughtful approach enables businesses to plan strategically and continuously improve their workplace inclusion efforts without encountering unexpected shifts.

About the “Equality 100 Award”

The CEI’s “Equality 100 Award” is a unique distinction and honors the work that companies have done to ensure a safe workplace for LGBTQ+ employees. The score is a

point-in-time measure and should not be taken as an absolute and final assessment of a business' LGBTQ+ inclusion efforts. The CEI and its associated score are one component of the greater framework of corporate citizenship, and the ways in which businesses can demonstrate meaningful allyship. In HRC's The LGBTQ+ Corporate Citizen – A Framework for Emerging Best Practices in Allyship Report, we identify pillars that stand alongside workplace inclusion, providing additional resources to businesses on how to build inclusion across business operations.

For more facts about the CEI, please see this document.

Why the CEI Matters

With over 1,400 companies rated annually, the CEI affects millions of employees and has helped set industry standards in LGBTQ+ inclusion. Even as employees and workplaces navigate anti-LGBTQ laws and policies in their states or federally, the CEI provides companies and employees with a clear set of tools to provide safe and affirming workplaces for the community permitted by law. This doesn't only help LGBTQ+ employees achieve equal pay and benefits for equal work but it helps reduce liability risk for companies, increase productivity of the workforce and benefit the company's bottom line.

The CEI encourages best practices in LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion, benefiting both employees and employers through talent attraction, retention, and workplace morale. Research consistently shows that fostering an inclusive workplace drives talent acquisition, boosts innovation, and helps drive business success. Additionally, with close to $1.4 trillion in spending power, LGBTQ+ consumers and investors are thoughtful about where they spend and invest their money. Ensuring LGBTQ+ employees and consumers feel welcomed and affirmed is not just equitable—it's smart business.

The Corporate Equality Index and the Landscape of Workplace Inclusion

In recent years, some activists have intensified their campaigns against corporate inclusion initiatives, seeking to undermine progress and mischaracterize these efforts as incompatible with business success – despite data proving otherwise. These anti-DEI campaigns attempt to misrepresent workplace inclusion efforts, galvanizing far-right voices to undermine core values and proven success factors for businesses.

These attacks on inclusion are not occurring in isolation but are part of a broader cultural and political movement aimed at rolling back progress for non-discrimination in the workplace -- progress that has helped level the playing field for LGBTQ+ people, people of color, women, people with disabilities and many others. Much of this anti-inclusion work began following the 2023 U.S. Supreme Court ruling that banned affirmative action in higher education,which has been exploited to apply pressure on private sector businesses. While the ruling itself did not directly impact corporate DEI practices, it gave opponents of inclusion a legal precedent to challenge and criticize diversity initiatives in the workplace, particularly those related to recruitment, promotion and termination.

At the same time, the political landscape has seen additional attacks on inclusion at both the

This external pressure, coupled with the broader political climate, has pushed some companies to reevaluate their workplace inclusion policies and practices. For the first time, businesses have issued public and employee communications backpedaling on previously established commitments to inclusion, raising significant concerns among employees about whether they will continue to be accepted and valued in their workplaces. Consumers have also responded, with many LGBTQ+ people and allies, as well as people of color, women and other diverse communities, wondering about these companies' commitment to their workers.

But despite these recent actions, the evidence in favor of workplace inclusion remains overwhelming. A 2024 report from Boston Consulting Group (BCG) highlights the measurable business benefits of inclusion initiatives demonstrating that organizations prioritizing inclusion outperform their peers in innovation, employee retention, and market responsiveness. Companies with diverse leadership teams generate 19% more revenue from innovation compared to less diverse peers–clear evidence of the financial advantages of building inclusive workplaces.

Additionally, millennials and Gen Z–who now make up a majority of the workforce–are more

state and federal levels. In 2024, lawmakers introduced – but did not pass – the *Dismantle DEI Act*, which seeks to eliminate DEI programs within the federal government and bars federal contracts to companies that engage in DEI practices. At the state level, 2024 also witnessed a continued surge in anti-LGBTQ+ legislative activity, with over 600 anti-LGBTQ+ bills introduced, many targeting the transgender community—particularly young people. These bills aimed to limit or restrict access to medically necessary healthcare gender affirming care, creating barriers to access safe and age appropriate medical care. Some of this legislation also aims to limit access to healthcare for transgender adults. Overall, 45 of these laws have passed into law this year alone.

likely to identify openly as LGBTQ+ themselves. With close to 30% of Gen Z adults identifying as LGBTQ+ and the community holding $1.4 trillion in spending power, workplace inclusion is an essential part of future-proofing business success. New data from the HRC Foundation further underscores the business risks companies face when retreating from inclusion-related commitments revealing that 80% of LGBTQ+ adults would boycott companies that roll back DEI efforts, with 76% agreeing that if a company rolled back DEI initiatives, they would have a less favorable opinion of that company.

of LGBTQ+ consumers view high CEI scores as an indicator of genuine support.

As efforts to undermine inclusion initiatives evolve, businesses must adapt to these pressures while staying anchored to values of fairness, equality, and inclusivity–essential drivers of long-term success. Adjustments to inclusion strategies may be necessary to

address immediate challenges, but that does not translate into wholesale dismantling of workplace inclusion in corporate America – the future of business success depends on it.

Twenty-two years ago, the CEI pioneered corporate benchmarking and established a clear connection between workplace inclusion and business performance. By participating, companies reinforce their commitment to transparency and inclusion, demonstrating to employees, customers and investors the importance an equitable workforce plays in driving financial growth. It also signals the belief that every employee deserves a welcoming and affirming workplace. As inclusion strategies evolve, the HRC Foundation's goal remains to serve as the preeminent and trusted resource for corporate leadership, providing clear legal guidance and a vision for best-in-class practices that ensure LGBTQ+ employees are treated fairly, and that policies and benefits are applicable and available to all employees, nothing more.

The Corporate Equality Index and its Impact on the Workforce

It has been the constant mission of the Human Rights Campaign Foundation, since its creation in 1980, to advocate for inclusive and equitable policies, practices, and protections for members of the LGBTQ+ community and their families. Significant progress has been made towards this goal, reflected in both societal attitudes and dedicated legislation to provide employment and discrimination protections for LGBTQ+ individuals.

A landmark moment came in 2015, with the Supreme Court decision in Obergefell v. Hodges, which granted same-sex couples the right to full, equal recognition under the law.

In 2020, the Bostock v. Clayton County decision reaffirmed that Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 protects LGBTQ+ employees from discrimination. In June 2021, the Biden administration reinstated protections against discrimination based on sexual orientation and gender identity under Section 1557 of the Affordable Care Act, ensuring transgender individuals access to essential health services without discrimination. Each of these achievements has profoundly impacted LGBTQ+ employees and their families.

While advancing policies and expanding benefits are crucial, the ultimate measure of success is the impact on the daily experiences and well-being of LGBTQ+ employees. In this section, we share employees' firsthand accounts of how the CEI has shaped their lives.

Imani credits her grocery chain's ERGs with her ability to contribute fully.

Imani (she/her), 40, works at a national grocery chain. Her experience highlights the profound impact of intentional inclusion by her employer. As a Black, queer woman, in previous roles Imani often felt her intersectionality was a barrier. But at her current company, she discovered it was her superpower. From her first day, she felt a strong sense of belonging, supported by a culture where diversity, equity, inclusion, and accessibility are top priorities. Imani's involvement in her LGBTQ+ Business Resource Group (BRG) further cemented this sense of inclusion. Her LGBTQ+ ERG encourages an environment where all associates feel welcomed and included.

LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Groups (ERGs) provide for connection between employees, allow for a space where employees can be their authentic selves, and are open to all employees. Data from HRC Foundation's Equality Rising report shows that 26% of LGBTQ+ workers have searched for a different job due to an environment that wasn't affirming and 28% have left

a job because the workplace was not accepting. ERGs can improve retention by fostering inclusivity and belonging.

For employers, ERGs can also drive innovation and business success. Through building community and belonging for underrepresented or marginalized groups, employees are afforded opportunities to build new skills, provide and receive mentorship, expand leadership experience, and enhance recruitment and retention of staff. These groups also serve as an internal focus group that can help inform key business drivers like marketing and product development, to ensure products and services reach intended audiences appropriately.

Alex's treatment on the job improved considerably when moving to a CEI-participating company.

When Alex (they/them), 26, entered the workforce 10 years ago, they felt the need to hide parts of themselves at work, pre-screening conversations and avoiding mentions of their personal life, even when their colleagues were sharing about their lives outside the workplace. This led to Alex feeling isolated and often unable to fully participate in the workplace experience. These feelings led Alex to search for a new job, with a workplace that would support them.

Everything began to change when they joined a large electronics company that is an active participant in the Corporate Equality Index. That employer had recently introduced an LGBTQ+ Associate Resource Group and Alex was able to join and be a part of creating the workplace culture they longed for earlier in their career. For

Today, Alex is able to participate in the workplace experience similar to their peers, including using the same pronoun at work they do at home and inviting coworkers to attend social events with their spouse. Like their peers, their pronouns are respected, even in their absence.

Business leaders know the importance of proper planning, communication, and training in implementing successful organizational change. A successful gender transition is no different. Gender Transition Guidelines provide a proactive plan leaders and employees can use to ensure transgender and non-binary employees are provided the same workplace experience as their peers. Written guidelines establish roles and responsibilities for transitioning employees,

the first time, Alex saw their employer taking meaningful steps toward creating a workplace where everyone was included. One of those efforts was developing a Gender Transition Guide for transgender employees—a project they helped draft.

their managers, and HR, ensuring consistency in managing transitions. This reduces the risk of mismanagement or non-compliance with non-discrimination policies.

Carlos and Thomas build a family through equal benefits offered by their company.

In 2015, Carlos (he/his) and Thomas (he/his) took the first step toward building their dream of starting a family together. After their wedding, they decided adoption was the best path to parenthood for them. While embarking on this journey, they knew they would need workplace support to balance becoming parents and continuing their careers.

Fortunately, their employer, a globally recognized firm, provided inclusive benefits that eased the way. These benefits included 16 weeks of gender-neutral parental leave, adoption reimbursement, and back-up childcare—resources that allowed the couple to focus on the adoption process and bond with their child after bringing them home.

Equivalency in access to family formation benefits allows LGBTQ+ to access the same care as their non-LGBTQ+ counterparts. Providing these benefits is about ensuring that LGBTQ+ employees have access to the same family-building opportunities that are available to all employees. These benefits are about ensuring that LGBTQ+ individuals have the ability to create families just as their non-LGBTQ+ counterparts do, without facing additional barriers or inequities.

Maria's mentorship program helped her advance skills and leadership roles.

In some cases, companies go beyond the guidance provided by the CEI to create an inclusive workplace. Maria's (she/her) experience at her Fortune 500 company was bolstered through the availability of mentorship programs, diversity training, and networking events that allowed her to gain new skills, broaden her perspective and build meaningful connections across the organization. Initiated through her interest in the various ERGs available at her company, Maria learned about additional inclusion efforts available to her. Through this experience she has deepened her involvement with her company's LGBTQ+ resource group and now leads mentoring initiatives, coaches allies, and organizes awareness events.

Together, these stories underscore how the CEI helps companies create environments where LGBTQ+ employees and their families thrive. By embedding inclusion into every aspect of workplace culture, employers can truly change lives.

*To protect the privacy and confidentiality of individuals, names in this document have been changed.

Despite the challenges posed this year creating inclusive workplaces for LGBTQ+ people, **765** businesses continued their work in creating welcoming and affirming workplaces earning 100 points in the 2025 CEI, receiving the distinction as “Equality 100 Award: Leader in LGBTQ+ Workplace Inclusion” Awardees.

This year’s CEI reflects continued growth in LGBTQ+ workplace equality and inclusion measures. HRC’s has continued its commitment to creating more equal workplaces for LGBTQ+ workers. In the CEI 2023-2024, HRC introduced a criteria evolution after actively listening to our corporate partners and the LGBTQ+ community on what measures assist in making workplaces feel more equal for all employees.

Companies have, once again, taken strides to meet this criteria. Through policies like assisting leaders when someone on their team is transitioning, employers providing opportunities for LGBTQ+ employees to self-disclose their LGBTQ+ identity, and resources that help LGBTQ+ employees find out what healthcare benefits are available to them without needing to out themselves, environments where LGBTQ+ employees feel welcomed and affirmed are once again on the rise. Companies are establishing essential policies that create safe and affirming workplace environments for all.

Continued Adoption of Evolved CEI Criteria

Transgender Inclusion in the Workplace: Healthcare and Beyond

The most considerable progress measured over the 20-year history of the CEI is the wide-scale

This year, in order to achieve top rating on the CEI, employers must provide gender transition

adoption of transgender-inclusive initiatives by participating businesses. These initiatives provide a more holistic approach to transgender inclusion in the workplace, it goes beyond inclusive healthcare offerings.

A full **95** percent of the Fortune 500 – including both companies that participate in the CEI survey and those that do not — have gender identity protections enumerated in their nondiscrimination policies (up from 3 percent in 2002). Notably, **98** percent of the entire CEI universe of businesses offer explicit gender identity non-discrimination protections (up from 5 percent in 2002).

72 percent of the Fortune 500 and **91** percent of all CEI-rated businesses (1317 of 1449 offer transgender-inclusive health insurance coverage, up from 0 per cent in 2002 – **28** times as many businesses as in 2009. Additionally, **58** new employers offer this coverage with the 2025 CEI.

guidelines to establish best practices for transgender inclusion in the workplace. Today, over one thousand employers use these guidelines to equip managers with a set of considerations and protocols for transitioning employees. 1,112 major employers reported the adoption of these guidelines in the 2025 CEI; this is up from 660 companies in 2022.

Additionally, employees shouldn't have to "out" themselves or have uncomfortable conversations with leadership when important life events occur in order to get access to applicable information, especially for LGBTQ+ employees. Creating a comprehensive guide that showcases what health benefits impact LGBTQ+ employees and their families is essential. This year, **75%** of our rated companies created LGBTQ+ benefits guides to ensure all employees know what inclusive benefits and services their employer provides.

Equality at the Fortune-Ranked Companies

224 OF THE FORTUNE 500-RANKED BUSINESSES achieved a 100-point rating in the 2025 CEI, with **19** of the **top 25** Fortune-ranked businesses at this top score. **95** percent of the Fortune 500 include "sexual orientation" and "gender identity" in their nondiscrimination policies. Over **72 percent** of Fortune 500

companies offer transgender-inclusive healthcare benefits.

In this year's report, **376** of Fortune 500 businesses have official CEI ratings based on submitted surveys , with an average rating of **88.** The Fortune 1000, a list of the largest publicly-traded and privately-held companies in the United States, was invited to take part in the Corporate Equality Index survey for the fourteenth year in a row.

Accelerating Global Equality

Although the push for LGBTQ+ inclusive workplaces began largely as an undertaking within the United States and Europe, the conversation around inclusivity is now pointedly more prominent among international stakeholders. The bottom line is undeniable – in a global marketplace, **equality knows no borders**.

Working hand-in-hand with both U.S.-based and international businesses, HRC made the case that inclusion efforts did not have to be contained to any one border. With many multinational companies employing persons outside of the United States, HRC encouraged CEI participants to consider how their adopted inclusive policies and practices could and would impact their workforces in countries with less tolerant legal and cultural stances towards LGBTQ+ communities.

To this effort, in 2016, the Corporate Equality Index criteria were expanded to require that companies with global operations extend their nondiscrimination policies across all their operations. This change helped drive more widespread adoption of nondiscrimination

policies that include sexual orientation and gender identity protections. In 2016, 54% of CEI-rated companies had global operations and 95 percent of those companies extended their LGBTQ+ inclusive nondiscrimination policies globally. With the 2025 CEI, **59** percent of rated companies have global operations and over **97** percent extend those protections globally.

The progress towards LGBTQ+ inclusion does not end with nondiscrimination policies. Companies continue to amplify their global LGBTQ+ inclusion efforts through the targeted expansion of equitable benefits and inclusive practices. Globally, companies are adopting critical benefits such as domestic partner recognition and transgender-inclusive healthcare benefits, as well as organizational training and capacity building. These companies are also deepening employee engagement efforts by expanding employee resource groups for LGBTQ+ workers and their allies.

In the past, and for this 2025 edition, the CEI survey collected information on global efforts to provide domestic partner benefits and transgender-inclusive benefits, support for global chapters of employee resource groups, and whether companies engage externally with LGBTQ+ communities outside the U.S. Across all categories, a majority of companies report extending these benefits and inclusive practices beyond U.S. borders.

1 At the HRC Foundation, we use the acronym “LGBTQ+” to represent the diversity of the greater lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and queer communities. We recognize that this acronym is U.S.-centric and that communities around the world recognize different identities and acronyms. When working in different communities, we adjust our language to reflect local customs.

Spotlight: HRC's Equidad/e Programs

Thanks to HRC's work with companies located within the United States, hundreds of thousands of LGBTQ+ employees and their families benefit from inclusive workplace policies, practices, and benefits. Following the unprecedented success of the CEI, many United States-based multinational companies became eager to replicate inclusive practices across their global footprint, leading to the HRC Foundation expanding into the business community in the Americas.

With the CEI as a model, HRC established a formal program aimed at growing LGBTQ+ inclusive practices and policies across workplaces in Mexico. After years of working with corporate partners, civil society organizations, and other stakeholders, including embassies and the American Chamber of Commerce (AmCham), the HRC Foundation partnered with **Alianza por la Diversidad e Inclusión Laboral (ADIL)** to officially launch the HRC Equidad MX: Workplace Equality Program in 2016. Since its inception, the pioneering program has experienced substantial growth in promoting LGBTQ+ inclusive workplaces throughout the country.

The groundbreaking success of HRC Equidad MX is reflected in the increasing number of companies participating in the survey and achieving top ratings for LGBTQ+ workplace equality. This year, **261** employers earned top

Next, the HRC Foundation expanded its LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion efforts to South America by partnering with **Fundación Iguales**, Chile's largest LGBTI+ advocacy group, to promote LGBTQ+ inclusive policies and protections among Chilean businesses and corporations through HRC Equidad CL. When the program launched in 2018, the Chilean-based program assessed **31** companies in its inaugural 2019 report and 15 of them received the HRC Foundation's designation of "Mejores Lugares para Trabajar LGBTI+." For the most recent report in 2024, a total of **151** companies were rated with **70** earning top scores. This marks a **367**% increase in top-scoring companies from Equidad CL's inaugural year.

Based on the success of the Equidad Programs in Mexico and Chile, the HRC Foundation expanded its efforts in South America to both Argentina and Brazil in 2021. Equidad AR was developed in partnership with **Instituto de Políticas Públicas LGBT**, and the number of participating companies has grown **55** percent, from 53 companies in its inaugural year to **82** companies in 2024. Of these, **56** earned the top score, a **155** percent increase from the **22** top scorers in 2022. Equidade BR, our first Portuguese-language program, was established with **Instituto Mais Diversidade**. In 2024, the program grew by **36** percent, rating a total of **124** companies with **79** earning the

ratings and the HRC Foundation's designation of "Best Places to Work for LGBTQ+ Equality" or "Mejores Lugares para Trabajar LGBTQ+" in the 2025 HRC Equidad MX report. This represents a **3** percent increase in the number of top-scoring employers over the prior year and, given that the initial report had **32** top-scorers, this is a **716** percent increase since the program's inaugural report in 2018.

maximum score. This marks a **108** percent increase from the **38** top scorers and a **107** percent increase from the **60** participating companies in 2022. To date, **662** companies are participating in the Equidad/e programs across Latin America, with over 150 new companies joining within the last year. We look forward to increasing our engagement over the coming year.

We invite all companies that have operations in Mexico, Chile, Argentina, and Brazil to encourage their regional counterparts to participate in our global programs and extend their support for LGBTQ+ inclusion in the workplace throughout the region. Through the CEI, Equidad MX, Equidad CL, Equidad AR, and Equidade BR programs, the HRC Foundation has established a framework to support LGBTQ+ inclusive policies, best practices, and benefits across national and international corporations, impacting nearly **25** million employees worldwide.

Learn more at
www.hrc.im/GlobalWorkplacePrograms

Quintuple Certification +

The following 7 companies have the distinction of earning top scores on all of HRC's Corporate Equality measures: the Corporate Equality Index, Equidad MX, Equidad CL, Equidad AR, and Equidade BR.

Currently, HRC and its partners are still in the process of collecting data for the 2025 survey reports

for Equidad CL, Equidad AR, and Equidade BR. Data used for these lists are from their most current reports.

Accenture

Bayer U.S. LLC

Boston Consulting Group

Ernst & Young LLP

JPMorgan Chase & Co.

Medtronic PLC

SAP America Inc.

Quadruple Certification +

The following 16 companies have the distinction of earning top scores on four of HRC's Corporate Equality measures.

Accor

Bristol-Myers Squibb Co.

Cognizant Technology Solutions Corp

Cummins Inc.

IBM Corp.

Lexmark

McDonald's Corporation

McKinsey & Co.

Merck

Nissan

Oracle Corp.

Procter & Gamble Co.

PepsiCo Inc.

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP

Thomson Reuters

Uber Technologies Inc.

Triple Certification

The following 29 companies have the distinction of earning top scores on three of HRC's Corporate Equality measures.

Amazon.com Inc.

American Airlines

Avery Dennison

Bain & Co. Inc./ Bridgespan Group

Bank of America Corp.

Capgemini Americas, Inc.

Cargill Inc.

Colgate-Palmolive Co.

Corteva Agriscience

ERM

FedEx Express

Intel Corp.

IPG Mediabrands

Johnson & Johnson

Kearney Inc.

KPMG LLP

ManpowerGroup

Marsh & McLennan Companies Inc.

Mattel Inc.

Reckitt

Salesforce

SC Johnson

Schneider Electric

Sodexo Inc.

Ternium

Unilever

The Walt Disney Company

Wabtec Corporation

Walmart

Double Certification

The following 62 companies have the distinction of earning top scores on two of HRC's Corporate Equality measures.

3M Company

ABB Inc.

AbbVie Inc.

Adidas

Alcon Inc.

American Express Company

Amgen Inc.

At&T Inc.

Atento

Baker & McKenzie LLP

British American Tobacco

BD

BlackRock

British Embassy

Carrier Global Corporation

CBRE nc.

Citigroup Inc.

Coca-Cola Co., The

Cushman & Wakefield

Diageo North America

Eaton Corp.

Ecolab Inc.

Edelman

Flex

GE Vernova

General Motors Co.

Genomma Lab

Gilead Sciences Inc.

Google Inc.

Greenberg Traurig

HSBC

Hyatt Hotels Corp.

IHG Hotels & Resorts

Ingredion

Mars Inc.

Mastercard

MetLife Inc.

Microsoft Corp.

Mondelez International

Nestlé

Nielsen

Nike Inc.

Omnicom

PayPal Holdings Inc.

Pfizer Inc.

Philip Morris International

QIAGEN

Randstad

S&P Global Inc.

Sanofi US

Scotiabank

Sephora

Softtek

Steelcase inc.

Syngenta

Teleperformance

Univar Solutions, Inc.

Volkswagen

Warner Music Group

Whirlpool Corp.

WTW- Willis Towers Watson

Xylem Inc.

THE CORPORATE EQUALITY INDEX 2025 asked participants a series of questions about LGBTQ+ inclusive policies, practices and benefits. These questions work to assess four categories of criteria, which are outlined in more detail in the Scoring Criteria section. Responses to some individual questions are reported in aggregate on the following pages to indicate national trends and facilitate benchmarking. Individual company scores based on the CEI criteria can be found online at www.hrc.org/cei/search.

Criteria 1: Workforce Protections

- Businesses' employment non-discrimination policy includes the terms "sexual orientation" and "gender identity or expression" (or "gender identity")

Criteria 2: Inclusive Benefits

- Businesses have equivalency in same- and different-sex spousal and domestic partner benefits in medical and other health benefits
- Businesses have equivalency in family formation benefits
- Businesses have equal health coverage for transgender individuals
- Businesses provide an LGBTQ+ Health Benefits Guide for its employees

Criteria 3: Supporting an Inclusive Culture

- Businesses provide training and education that includes coverage about LGBTQ+ discrimination
- Businesses capture demographic data that includes LGBTQ+ individuals
- Businesses have transgender inclusive best practices
- Businesses have either an LGBTQ+ employee resource group or diversity council

Criteria 4: Corporate Social Responsibility

- Businesses have outreach or engagement efforts to the broader LGBTQ+ community
- Businesses include the LGBTQ+ community in corporate social responsibility (supplier standards and philanthropic giving guidelines).

Criteria 1: Workforce Protections

THE WORKFORCE PROTECTIONS criteria of the CEI call for a written employment non-discrimination policy across all operations that includes both “sexual orientation” and “gender identity”. For companies with operations outside of the U.S., the policy must also be extended across the global workforce.

Lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, and queer people continue to face discrimination in employment because of their sexual orientation and/or gender identity, creating a need for explicit non-discrimination policies. The 2020 SCOTUS ruling of Bostock v. Clayton County, which cemented that discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity is a form of sex discrimination prohibited by Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, supports this foundational requirement.

of CEI participants (1420 of 1449respondents) documented that they include “sexual orientation” and “gender identity” in their employment non-discrimination policy.

Clearly enumerated non-discrimination protections based on sexual orientation and gender identity are essential to LGBTQ+ workforce equity and inclusion. The policies help to ensure:

- **Equal opportunity for all employees;**
- **Diverse talent acquisition and retention for broader economic growth; and,**
- **Employers are kept apace with changing legal and public opinion landscapes.**

Furthermore, these policies represent minimal upfront costs. Rates of litigation, upon implementation, are consistent with other protected classes.

Criteria 2: Inclusive Benefits

IN THE U.S., EMPLOYER-PROVIDED HEALTH INSURANCE IS THE SINGLE LARGEST source of healthcare coverage. Competitive employer-provided benefits packages are critical to attracting and retaining talent. Widespread employer adoption of such packages helps to ensure that offering LGBTQ+ inclusive benefits to employees and their families is a low-cost, high-return proposition for businesses. In addition, equitable benefits structures align with the principle of equal compensation for equal work. Apart from actual wages paid, benefits can account, on average, for approximately **30** percent of employees' overall compensation (BOL 2019). By amending their benefits structures, employers ensure that they extend this valuable bundle of benefits to their workforce equitably, irrespective of sexual orientation and gender identity.

Most employers have reported an overall increase of less than **3.5** percent in total benefits costs when they implement partner benefits and marginal increases related to transgender-inclusive healthcare coverage (i.e., a fraction of a decimal point of cost calculations).

The HRC Foundation rates and gives guidance on three key components of equal health insurance benefits:

- **Parity between benefits available for employees' spouses and partners;**
- **Parity in the provision of family formation benefits for employees' spouses and partners; and**
- **Transgender-inclusive healthcare benefits that offer equal access to healthcare and removal of all broad exclusions to healthcare coverage across plan offerings.**

In addition, employers are rated on having full parity across their entire suite of benefits – including non-healthcare benefits such as leave, retirement, and others – between spouses and partners.

LGBTQ+ inclusive benefits packages are:

- **Necessary for talent acquisition and retention and broader economic growth;**
- **Equal compensation for equal work;**
- **Helping employers keep pace with changing legal landscape and workforce expectations; and,**
- **Harbor minimal upfront costs (on average 1% increase for corporate employers' overall health insurance costs).**

The premise of parity underlies the inclusive benefits section of the CEI criteria. In its CEI scoring, the HRC Foundation does not penalize an employer if a particular benefit is not offered to any employees but holds employers accountable to provide LGBTQ+ employees and their families with the same benefits available to other employees across available benefits packages. For example, where routine care, hormone therapies, and medically necessary surgeries are available to cisgender (non-transgender) people, these same healthcare benefits must also be extended to transgender people covered by the plan. Many employers have begun to comprehensively address health insurance coverage for transgender individuals, and most have experienced insignificant or no premium increases as a result.

Continued Need for Partner Benefits

Since 2002, the CEI has required parity between spousal and partner benefits. After the *United States v. Windsor* and before the *Obergefell v. Hodges* Supreme Court rulings, HRC released a position paper cautioning against a marriage-only standard for accessing healthcare coverage, which is an unreasonable standard given the many other legal vulnerabilities beyond their right to marry that continue to affect LGBTQ+ individuals' freedom.

Since the 2015 U.S. Supreme Court decision in *Obergefell v. Hodges*, which brought marriage equality nationwide by ruling that marriage is a fundamental right to which same-sex couples should have the same access as opposite-sex couples, employers have sought to do the right thing in the name of equality and provide spousal benefits to both same- and different-sex married couples. In December 2022, the U.S. Senate passed the Respect for Marriage Act (RMA) — a bill that codifies federal marriage equality by guaranteeing the federal rights, benefits and obligations of marriages in the federal code;

repeals the discriminatory Defense of Marriage Act (DOMA); and affirms that public acts, records and proceedings should be recognized by all states. By doing so, it protects the status quo that exists following the U.S. Supreme Court's landmark rulings in *Loving v. Virginia* (1967), *Windsor v. United States* (2013) and *Obergefell v. Hodges* (2015) — decisions that together made equal marriage the law of the land.

While marriage equality is undoubtedly a monumental step toward full equality, LGBTQ+ individuals remain at risk for discrimination in many other aspects of daily life. Until LGBTQ+ Americans have full equality through the federal Equality Act, domestic partner benefits will remain an essential CEI standard that helps to fill the void left by federal and state law and ensure LGBTQ+ workers and their families receive equitable benefits whether married or partnered.

Domestic partner benefits do not only serve same-sex couples. In fact, over the last decade, most businesses that have offered same-sex partner benefits also extended these to different-sex partners–which is a requirement in the CEI to receive any points. Employers have increasingly recognized the value of providing necessary benefits to meet the needs of their diverse workforces.

In total, **1098** businesses met the standard in this year's survey. The CEI continues to reflect best practices for LGBTQ+ workers and their families.

of CEI participants (1098 of 1449 respondents) documented that they provide inclusive benefits for same- and different-sex spouses and partners.

Understanding Transgender-Inclusive Healthcare Coverage

In 2004, the HRC Foundation identified transgender-inclusive healthcare coverage as a focus area for educational outreach and as a scored component of the CEI criteria.

From 2006 through 2011, a top CEI score meant businesses needed to mitigate at least one exclusion among five critical categories of transgender healthcare, namely: mental health, pharmacy benefits for hormone therapy, medical visits and lab procedures related to hormone therapy, surgical procedures, and short-term leave for surgical procedures. While awareness of barriers to transgender healthcare coverage steadily increased, a majority of CEI-rated businesses plateaued in offering mental healthcare coverage and/or short-term leave for surgical procedures and did not mitigate exclusions related to other medically necessary treatments.

In 2009, the HRC Foundation announced a major change to what would be the 2012 CEI criteria. To earn a score of 100, a business needed not just to mitigate one or more exclusions but also to address the root problem of transgender exclusion in coverage and

fully affirm healthcare coverage for medically necessary transition-related care and other routine and chronic conditions. The HRC Foundation embarked on a massive campaign of educational and consultative efforts to address healthcare and insurance disparities for the transgender population and their families, including outreach to leading health insurance companies, direct consultation with both fully- and self-insured employers to modify their health insurance plans, and collection and dissemination of cost and utilization data from leading businesses.

of CEI-rated businesses (1317 of 1449 respondents) offer at least one transgender-inclusive plan option with current market standard coverage, up from 0 in 2002 and just 8% in the 2009 CEI report. This year, of the 1317 businesses with at least one inclusive plan, 1258 also eliminated all exclusions across plans.

Growth of Trans Benefits Over Time

Criteria 3: Supporting an Inclusive Culture

LGBTQ+ Internal Training and Accountability

of CEI-rated employers (1094 of 1449 respondents) offer a robust set of practices (at least four efforts) to support organizational LGBTQ+ diversity competency.

Equitable policies and benefits are critical to LGBTQ+ inclusion in the workforce but alone are not sufficient to support a truly inclusive culture within a workplace. Employers recognize that beyond the letter of a policy, additional programming and educational efforts are necessary.

Ultimately, businesses invest in organizational competency programs because:

- **Policy does not equal practice;**
- **Invisible diversity requires unique training focus and defined safe space programs and resources. Which is why intersectional education is key to any inclusive workplace;**
- **Senior-level buy-in and accountability metrics effect change quickly and for the long term; and,**
- **Retaining workers is largely about everyday experiences on the job.**

Many employers integrate educational programs into already existing diversity and inclusion programs. To obtain full credit in this criterion, employers must show at least four types of organizational competency programs and one of those programs needs to

include the core components of intersectionality in the workplace. LGBTQ+ workers hold multiple identities and those who carry more than one historically marginalized identity, move through the world and the workplace with an experience that's greater than the sum of its parts. That is why we require that businesses provide explicit intersectionality training to their workforce. This comprehensive metric is provided as accountability for employers to devote resources to creating and maintaining a climate of inclusion.

Some of the most common forms of LGBTQ+ inclusion efforts are:

- **Diversity training programs such as new hire, manager, and professional development training;**
- **Performance evaluation mechanisms for senior leadership; and,**
- **Integration of intersectionality in professional development, skills-based or other trainings**

of CEI-rated employers (1216 of 1449 respondents) have Managers/Supervisors undergo training that includes gender identity and sexual orientation as discrete topics (this may be a part of a broader training), and provides definitions or scenarios illustrating the policy for each.

of CEI-rated employers (1196 of 1449 respondents) have integrated intersectionality into their training offerings in professional development, skills-based, or other training.

of CEI-rated employers (772 of 1449 respondents) include LGBTQ+ diversity metrics as part of senior management/executive leadership performance standards.

LGBTQ+ Data Collection

It is imperative to the future success of any company to understand the lived experiences of your workers to ensure implemented policies and practices have the intended impact. In order to do so, employers have sought ways to learn more about their workforce by building intentional initiatives that impact every employee in a positive way. For example, employee reported self-ID data may help employers determine underrepresentation in hiring or to understand pay equity across different demographics, strengthening

employee recruitment and retention efforts. Asking your employees to share details about themselves and their families can be seem like a risky thing for some employees, especially collecting data on identities that have historically not been accepted in the workplace or deemed “unprofessional” based on limited and outdated concepts of professionalism, especially those concepts rooted in assimilation versus individuality.

Companies have previously employed methods of collecting this data, such as LGBTQ+ employee resource group membership, but this method is limited and has yielded minimal data to take action. More recently employers have gathered statistics via employee engagement surveys and through confidential and secure employee records. These engagement surveys and HR information systems include optional questions that allow LGBTQ+ employees to self-identify based on gender identity or sexual orientation. This year, HRC continues to see a record number of companies collecting LGBTQ+ data from their employees. **866** companies are tracking sexual orientation and gender identity in their human resource information systems (HRIS), which is a **84%** increase in just two CEI cycles (CEI 2022).

of CEI-rated employers (593 of 1449 respondents) allow employees the option to self-identify as LGBTQ+ in anonymous employee engagement surveys or as part of data collection on confidential employee forms.

of CEI participants(866 of 1449 respondents) allow self-identification in the HRIS system. This is an 88% growth in just two CEI cycles.

Self-identification can also be impactful in businesses’ board rooms. LGBTQ+ board directors remain underrepresented in the board room. Including sexual orientation and gender identity alongside other secure and confidential demographic data collection both

creates space for LGBTQ+ board members in these circles but also further allows businesses to understand their constituency.

of CEI-rated employers (660 of 1449 respondents) include LGBTQ+ diversity metrics as part of Board self-identification data collection efforts.

Transgender Inclusion Best Practices

When businesses are committed to creating safe and inclusive workplaces, that can only be achieved when all employees are included. Providing equal healthcare and wellness benefits is one component for this inclusion, but that's not all employers can do. Fair-minded employers seeking the best and brightest want to close the gaps between inclusive policies and their own practices and cultural understanding of gender diversity to create welcoming and productive workplaces for all employees, including those who are transgender and non-binary.

Businesses may encounter employees transitioning on the job and a workplace transition involves change not only for the employee but also for their manager, colleagues, and clients. Business leaders know the importance of proper planning, communication, and training in implementing successful organizational change. Gender transition guidelines, a written set of guidelines to manage an on-the-job gender transition, lead HR professionals, managers and

transitioning employees through a proactive planning process. In the 2025 CEI, **1,112** employers have instituted gender transition guidelines to support transitioning employees, their managers and their colleagues.

of CEI-rated employers (1112 of 1449 respondents) have instituted Gender Transition Guidelines with supportive policies and documentation guidance to proactively support transitioning employees, their managers and their colleagues.

Additionally, policies like gender-neutral dress codes, transgender inclusive restroom and facility policies, and guidance for employees with details on how to display their chosen name and display their pronouns in directories, each also are parts of creating a more inclusive workplace for transgender and non-binary employees. Adopting inclusive practices in the workplace helps foster a more accepting and affirming workplace for transgender and non-binary individuals and can mitigate the risk of discriminatory workplaces.

of CEI-rated employers (1051 of 1449 respondents) have instituted workplace policies that provide a safe and affirming experience for transgender and non-binary workers.

These policies include transgender-inclusive restroom guidance, gender-neutral dress codes and how an employee's information is displayed, such as procedures for changing names and pronouns throughout company-wide databases.

LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Group or Diversity Council

Many large employers have formally recognized employee resource groups (ERGs), also known as employee networks, business resources, or affinity groups, for diverse populations of their workforce, including women, people of color, veterans, parents, people of varied abilities, and LGBTQ+ people and their allies. The purpose of these groups is two-fold:

- **To foster a sense of community and visibility of these diverse populations within a business; and**
- **To leverage each unique populations' networks and skills to help accomplish business goals such as market innovation, recruitment and retention of talent.**

Employee resource groups are great platforms for leadership opportunities for LGBTQ+ and allied employees to better their own work environments. In addition, the reach of many ERGs extends beyond the everyday affairs of an employer to policy making, representing the employer at professional events and external activities, participating in prospective employee recruitment efforts, mentoring, and other retention-focused programming.

Employee resource groups that are focused on the LGBTQ+ workforce empower employees as change agents and promote inclusion for LGBTQ+ employees within the workplace. Recognizing the differences in businesses rated in the CEI, this criterion can also be met with an organization-wide diversity council or working group with a mission that specifically includes LGBTQ+ diversity and inclusion.

of CEI-rated employers (1416 of 1449 respondents) have an employee resource group or diversity council that includes LGBTQ+ and allied employees and programming.

Employees who do not identify as LGBTQ+ themselves, but are invested in workplace inclusion and equality, are increasing their numbers within ERG ranks. While mission statements of ERGs are specific to LGBTQ+ inclusion, an increasing number of ally-

identified colleagues are encouraged to join as membership is not limited to those who are LGBTQ+ but is open to all supporters of equality.

of those companies with an officially recognized LGBTQ+ employee group (1312 of 1337) report the ERG is expressly for LGBTQ+ and Allied employees.

ERGs have embraced allies as critical supporters of the full LGBTQ+ community, as allies bring their own unique voice and vantage point to workplace equality. The profile and impact of an employee resource group is greatly enhanced by an active executive champion for the group.

of employee groups reported in the CEI (1284 of 1337) are sponsored by an executive champion.

Criteria 4 - Corporate Social Responsibility

Efforts in Outreach and Engagement to Broader LGBTQ+ Community

of CEI-rated businesses (1044 of 1449 respondents) met the standard of demonstrating at least five efforts of public commitment to the LGBTQ+ community.

Businesses have extensive programs to engage with key markets and the communities in which they operate. Public commitment in the CEI is measured through a number of individual engagements, namely through:

LGBTQ+ employee recruitment efforts as well as;

- **LGBTQ+ supplier diversity programs;**
- **Marketing and advertising to LGBTQ+ consumers;**
- **Philanthropic support of LGBTQ+ organizations or events;**
- **Public policy weigh-in; and**
- **LGBTQ+ inclusive products and services**

Businesses see advantages in going public with their commitment to equality, including:

- **Reputational benefits to supporting equality groups and programs;**
- **A corporate case for LGBTQ+ legal equality: they are on the right side of history and eliminate barriers to investment;**

- **Attracting and retaining next generation of workers and consumers – the importance of communicating pro-equality messages to millennials; and,**
- **LGBTQ+ public support is seen as a bellwether for broader issues of diversity and inclusion.**

Recruiting

Professional events such as the annual Out & Equal Workplace Summit, the Lavender Law Conference, and the Reaching Out MBA (ROMBA) Conference and Career Expo are filled with highly-rated CEI employers looking to attract diverse employees. Employers' presence at these and other events sends a clear message to potential employees that LGBTQ+ diversity is part of company culture, and that LGBTQ+ candidates are valued as the best and the brightest across industries, geographies and trades. This year, companies recruited at a much higher rate than in previous years with 991 businesses engaging in recruitment–this represents a 62% increase from the CEI 2023-2024.

of CEI-rated businesses (991 of 1449 respondents) attended an LGBTQ+ specific recruiting event or function.

Supplier Diversity

Supplier diversity programs ensure that the procurement process includes specific opportunities for minority-owned businesses, including women-owned, veteran-owned and, more recently, LGBTQ+ owned businesses. Supplier diversity initiatives have existed in the business community for at least three decades, going back to the inception of such groups like the National Association of Women Business Owners and the National Minority Business Council, both founded in the early 1970s to promote the inclusion of these under-utilized entrepreneurial groups. Furthermore, there are federal initiatives such as the Center for Veterans Enterprise that are designed to assist U.S. veterans in launching and thriving in private business. These initiatives intend to give more equitable opportunities to those would-be small business owners who are more likely to face social and practical barriers to success.

The National LGBT Chamber of Commerce began certifying LGBTQ+ owned small businesses in 2002, a process that requires substantiation of majority LGBTQ+ ownership in a business and verification of a business' good standing in the community. Supplier diversity initiatives are a win-win relationship for both the LGBTQ+ owned small businesses and the businesses that contract them.

of CEI-rated businesses with supplier diversity programs (876 of 981) specifically include LGBTQ+ owned enterprises in their programs.

These businesses are enjoying a multitude of benefits, including a supply chain that better reflects the diverse communities in which they operate, and in turn, garnering sharper innovation and business solutions.

Marketing & Advertising

Ad campaigns and sponsorships further this message of company values to the public. Increasingly, ads with authentic images of LGBTQ+ people are featured in both LGBTQ+ media outlets and general press alike. With 1.4 trillion dollars in spending power, marketing and advertising to the LGBTQ+ community can also support companies' bottom lines.

of CEI-rated businesses (1019 of 1449 respondents) ran LGBTQ+ specific ads or marketing content or sponsored LGBTQ+ inclusive events such as Pride.

Philanthropy

Corporate philanthropic activities ranging from financial support to in-kind donations of products or services can bolster a business's profile in the LGBTQ+ community. Corporate giving to organizations promoting LGBTQ+ health, education or political efforts further demonstrates this commitment to broader LGBTQ+ equality. Typically, these efforts have a strategic connection to the core mission of a business, such as a law

firm's pro bono legal support of organizations tasked with direct legal representation of LGBTQ+ individuals.

of CEI-rated businesses (1162 of 1384 respondents) provided philanthropic support via cash or in-kind donation to at least one LGBTQ+ specific organization.

Corporate Social Responsibility

A business's non-discrimination policies should not be limited to human resources or diversity and inclusion. The CEI's Corporate Social Responsibility criteria ensure that sexual orientation and gender identity protections apply to those standards that businesses require their vendors or suppliers to adhere to, as well as recipients of their philanthropic funds.

Supplier/Vendor Standards Include LGBTQ+ Nondiscrimination

Large businesses typically rely on other businesses for goods or services, and businesses of the size included in the CEI typically have set standards and guidelines already embedded in their procurement. To ensure that suppliers act in a manner that

adheres to a business's own standards, businesses must establish standards of conduct that set expectations for behavior of their suppliers.

of rated employers in this year's CEI have supplier mandates with respect to non-discrimination in place, and 98% of these mandates (1197 of 1227 companies) explicitly include sexual orientation and gender identity alongside other named categories.

Philanthropic Giving Guidelines

The HRC Foundation has always held businesses accountable for the types of organizations receiving their philanthropic dollars. Historically, the CEI had a mechanism to account for foundational corporate giving to any organization whose explicit mission included efforts to undermine LGBTQ+ equality. This framework was widened in 2016 to hold companies accountable for any giving to a non-religious organization with an explicit policy of discrimination against LGBTQ+ people. This requirement sets the standards around responsible foundational giving and ensures that a top-rated business does not provide philanthropic support to organizations whose values do not align with theirs.

To be LGBTQ+ inclusive, businesses should review their philanthropic giving guidance to ensure that any giving (financial or in-kind) is not available to any non-religious organizations that have a written policy of discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation

and gender identity or have a policy explicitly permitting its own chapters, affiliates, etc. to discriminate.

of CEI-rated businesses (1221 of 1449 respondents) have written guidelines that prohibit philanthropic support of non-religious organizations with an explicit policy of discrimination towards LGBTQ+ people.

Spotlight: Corporate Initiatives Including the Count Us In Pledge and Business Coalition for the Equality Act

HRC is proud to partner with leading employers on corporate initiatives that drive equality. These corporate initiatives include the Business Statement on Anti-LGBTQ+ State Legislation with over 300 major employer signatories, the LGBTQ Refugees Mentorship Initiative, and Working Positively, which invites employers to commit to being visible role models in support of HIV-positive employees and other chronic illnesses.

The latest employer activation with HRC is the Count Us In Pledge, an effort to elevate the business sector's allyship and voice in support of transgender and non-binary people, particularly employees and their families. The pledge, endorsed by over 100 major employers across various sectors, demonstrates a unified commitment to standing in solidarity with the LGBTQ+ community. This action follows HRC's declaration of a state of emergency in 2023, with signatories committing to the following:

- To be proud and public LGBTQ+ allies, calling on lawmakers to abandon any efforts to discriminate and reject anti-LGBTQ threats to company values of diversity, equity, and inclusion.
- To raise up honest and authentic experiences of LGBTQ+ Americans, including those of employees and customers in the transgender and non-binary community; and
- To ensure transgender and non-binary employees and their families have access to the health and medical care they need, where possible under the law.

And one of the largest coalition initiatives is the Business Coalition for the Equality Act. HRC's Business Coalition for the Equality Act is a group of 557 leading U.S. employers that support the Equality Act, federal legislation that would provide the same basic protections to LGBTQ+ people that are provided to other federally protected groups. Coalition member companies represent nearly every industry, **employ over 16 million people** in the U.S., command over **$7.8 trillion** in revenue, and have **operations in all 50 states.**

The Equality Act creates clear, consistent protections to prohibit discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity in employment ensuring that LGBTQ+ employees are hired, fired, and promoted based on their performance. In addition, the bill provides protections from discrimination in housing, credit, and jury service for LGBTQ+ people. The bill also prohibits discrimination in public spaces and services and protects against discrimination in the receipt of federal funding on the basis of sex, sexual orientation, and gender identity.

The historic *Obergefell v. Hodges* case in 2015 gave same-sex couples the right to marriage, and, since then, state legislators across the country have responded by proposing hundreds of anti-LGBTQ+ bills. However, companies opposed (and still oppose) these discriminatory bills. Over the last eight years, countless companies in all 50 states have spoken out against attempts to undermine LGBTQ+ civil rights. Discriminatory bills that attempt to curb access to public services for transgender people, deny basic services to LGBTQ+ families, or preempt local nondiscrimination ordinances put company employees, employee families, and customers at risk.

CEI-rated employers are on record supporting broad issues of LGBTQ+ equality at the local, state, and federal levels, including through amicus briefs that are submitted during court cases to support pro-LGBTQ+ legislation and rulings. Private sector support for the federal Equality Act surged within the last three years and, at present, 557 major employers are signatories on HRC's *The Business Coalition for the Equality Act*.

1-800-FLOWERS.COM, Inc.

2U, Inc.

3M Company

ABB Inc.

AbbVie Inc.

Abercrombie & Fitch Co.

Accenture

Adobe Inc.

ADP

Advance Auto Parts

E. I. du Pont de Nemours and Co. (DuPont)

*E*TRADE Financial Corp.*

E&J Gallo Winery

Eastern Bank

Eaton Corp.

eBay Inc.

Ecolab Inc.

Edison International

Edward Jones

Novartis Pharmaceuticals Corporation

Novo Nordisk Inc.

NRP Group, The

NTT DATA Services, LLC

Nuance Communications

OCC (Options Clearing Corporation)

Ocean Spray Cranberries Inc.

Office Depot Inc.

Omnicom Group

Advanced Micro Devices Inc.

Aegon Asset Management

Aflac Inc.

Air Products

Airbnb

Airbus Americas

Akamai Technologies, Inc.

Alaska Airlines

Albertsons Companies

Alcoa Corp.

AlixPartners LLP

AllianceBernstein

Ally

Altice USA Inc.

Altria Group Inc.

Amalgamated Bank

Amazon

American Airlines

American Eagle Outfitters Inc.

Elastic NV

Eli Lilly and Company

EMD Serono, MilliporeSigma and EMD Electronics

Emerson

Empower Retirement

Equinix

Equitable

Ericsson Inc

Ernst & Young LLP

Estée Lauder Companies Inc.

Etsy, Inc.

Eventbrite

Eversource Energy

Evolent

Exelon

Expedia Group

FactSet Research Systems Inc.

Fairview Health Services

Fiserv Inc.

Oportun, Inc.

Oracle Corporation

Otis Worldwide Corporation

Owens Corning

Palo Alto Networks

Pariveda Solutions

Patagonia

Patreon

Paul Hastings LLP

Paylocity

PayPal

PC Connection Inc. (dba Connection)

Peloton Interactive, Inc.

PepsiCo

PetSmart, LLC

Pfizer

PG&E Corp.

Philip Morris International

Pinterest

American Electric Power Co. Inc.

American Express

American Express Global Business Travel

American Honda Motor Company

Ameriprise Financial, Inc.

AMN Healthcare

Amyris, Inc.

Analog Devices, Inc.

Andersen Corporation

Ansys, Inc.

Anywhere Real Estate

Aon PLC

Apple

Applied Materials, Inc.

Arcadis U.S. Inc.

Arconic

ArentFox Schiff LLP

Asana, Inc.

FMC Corporation

Food Lion

Ford Motor Company

Fossil Group Inc.

GAP, Inc

GE Appliances, a Haier Company

Gen Digital

General Electric Co.

General Mills

General Motors

GIANT Food Stores LLC

Giant of Maryland LLC

Gilead Sciences, Inc.

Ginkgo Bioworks

Glassdoor

GSK

GoDaddy

Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Google

Pioneer Natural Resources

PNC Financial Services Group

Point B, Inc.

Point32Health

Polsinelli PC

Porter Wright Morris & Arthur LLP

Portland General Electric

Power Home Remodeling

PPL Corporation

Precision Medicine Group, LLC

PwC

Principal Financial Group

Procter & Gamble Co.

Pure Storage Inc.

PVH Corp.

Q-Centrix

QIAGEN

QUALCOMM Inc.

R1 RCM Inc.

Ascena

Aspen Skiing Company LLC

Associated Bank

AstraZeneca

Asurion LLC

AT&T

Atlassian

Autodesk

AvalonBay Communities, Inc.

Avery Dennison Corporation

Avita Care Solutions/QCare+

Avnet, Inc.

BAE Systems Inc.

Bain & Co. Inc./ Bridgespan Group

Baker & McKenzie LLP

Baker Tilly US

Bank of America Corp.

Barclays

BASF Corporation

GP Strategies Corporation

Grant Thornton LLP

Great River Energy

Greenspoon Marder LLP

Greenway Health, LLC

Grove Collaborative

Guardian Life Insurance Co. of America

Guidehouse Inc.

Guild

Gusto

Hannaford Supermarkets

Harley-Davidson Motor Company

Henkel Corporation (North America)

HERE North America LLC

Herrick, Feinstein LLP

Hershey Co., The

Hess Corp.

Hewlett Packard Enterprise

Radian Group Inc.

Ralph Lauren Corporation

RAPP Worldwide

Raymond James Financial

RE/MAX LLC

Red Hat Inc.

RedFin Real Estate

REI Co-op

Relias LLC

RELX

Replacements Ltd.

RES (Renewable Energy Systems)

Rockland Trust Co.

Rockwell Automation Inc.

Royal Bank of Canada

S&C Electric Company

S&P Global Inc.

Salesforce

Samsung Electronics America

Bayer US LLC

BCW (Burson Cohn & Wolfe)

BD (Becton, Dickinson and Co.)

BDO USA, PC

Berkshire Bank

Best Buy Co. Inc.

Billtrust

Biogen

BioMarin Pharmaceutical Inc.

Bird Rides Inc.

Black & Veatch Holding Inc.

Black Knight, Inc.

BlackRock

Block Inc.

Bloomberg LP

Blue Cross & Blue Shield of Rhode Island

Blue Ridge Power

BMC Software Inc.

BNP Paribas

Hexion

Hilton

Hiscox USA

Hogan Lovells US LLP

Holland & Knight LLP

Home Depot Inc., The

Honeywell International

Host Hotels & Resorts Inc.

HP Inc.

HSBC US

HSF Affiliates LLC

HSN Inc.

Hughes Hubbard & Reed LLP

Husch Blackwell LLP

Hyatt

IBM Corp.

ICM Partners

IDEX Corp.

IGT

IHG Hotels & Resorts

Sanofi US

SAP

Saul Ewing Arnstein & Lehr LLP

Schulte Roth & Zabel LLP

Seagate Technology plc

Securian Financial Group Inc.

Selective Insurance Company of America

ServiceSource International, Inc.

Seyfarth Shaw LLP

Sheppard, Mullin, Richter, & Hampton LLP

Shipt, Inc.

Shire PLC

Shook, Hardy & Bacon LLP

Shutterstock

Siemens Corp.

Siemens Healthineers, USA

Signet Jewelers

SiriusPoint Ltd.

Slalom

Body Shop, The

Boehringer Ingelheim USA

Boies Schiller Flexner LLP

Booz Allen Hamilton Inc.

Boston Beer Company

Boston Celtics

Boston Consulting Group

Boston Scientific

Box, Inc.

bp

Bread Financial

Bridgestone Americas Holding Inc.

Bridgewater Associates LP

Brigham and Women's Hospital

Bright Health Group

Bright Horizons Family Solutions

Bristol-Myers Squibb Co.

Broadridge Financial Solutions Inc.

Brooks Sports Inc

IHS Markit

IKEA

Impossible Foods

Information Resources Inc.

Infosys

Ingersoll-Rand Company

Ingram Micro

Insight Enterprises Inc.

Instacart

Intel

International Flavors & Fragrances Inc.

Iron Mountain Inc.

J. M. Smucker Co., The

J.Crew Group

Jacobs

Jeni's Splendid Ice Creams

Jenner & Block LLP

JetBlue Airways Corp.

John Hancock

Smurfit WestRock

Sodexo Inc.

Sony Corporation of America

Sony Electronics Inc.

Sony Interactive Entertainment

Sony Music Group

Southwest Airlines Co.

Splunk

Spotify USA Inc.

Standard Chartered Bank

Stanley Black & Decker Inc.

Starbucks

State Street Corporation

Steelcase Inc.

Stop & Shop Supermarket Company, LLC

Strategic Education, Inc.

SUEZ Water Technologies and Solutions

SunLife

Sunrun Inc.

Brown Harris Stevens

Brown Rudnick LLP

Brown-Forman Corp.

Buckley LLP

C.H. Robinson

Caesars Entertainment Corp.

California Water Service Group

Capgemini Americas, Inc.

Capital Group

Capital Markets Company

Capital One Financial Corp.

Capri Holdings Limited

Cardinal Health

CareSource

Cargill

Cargo Transporters, Inc.

CarGurus

Carlson

Carlyle Group, LP, The

Cengage Learning Inc.

Johnson & Johnson

Johnson Controls Inc.

Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL)

JP Morgan Chase & Co.

JSX

Juniper Networks Inc.

Kabbage Inc.

Kaiser Permanente

Kearney

Keller Williams Realty Inc.

Kellogg Company

Kenneth Cole Productions

Kerry

KeyCorp

KIND LLC

The Knot Worldwide

KnowBe4, Inc.

Korn Ferry

KPMG LLP

Kraft Heinz

SurveyMonkey Inc.

Sweetgreen, Inc.

Synchrony Financial

Sysco Corporation

T-Mobile

Takeda Pharmaceuticals, U.S.A., Inc.

Tapestry Inc.

Target

TD Ameritrade

TD Bank, N.A.

Tech Data Corp.

TEGNA Inc.

Tesla Inc.

Teva Pharmaceuticals

Texas Instruments

Thermo Fisher Scientific

TIAA

Tiffany & Co.

Tillamook County Creamery Association

Cerner Corporation

Chapman and Cutler LLP

Chevron Corp.

Children's Minnesota

Chime

Chobani

Choice Hotels International Inc.

Chubb

CIGNA Corp.

Cisco Systems, Inc.

Citigroup Inc.

Citrix Systems Inc.

Clorox Company

CME Group Inc.

CNA Insurance

Coca-Cola Co.

CohnReznick, LLP

Comcast NBCUniversal

Compass

L3Harris Technologies

Lendlease Americas Inc.

Lennox International

Levi Strauss & Co.

Linden Research Inc.

Lord, Abbett & Co. LLC

Lowenstein Sandler LLP

Lumentum Holdings, LLC

Lush Fresh Handmade Cosmetics

Lyft Inc.

Macy's, Inc

Mallinckrodt LLC

ManpowerGroup

Marriott International, Inc.

Mars, North America

Marsh McLennan

MassMutual

Mastercard

Match Group, LLC

Toyota Motor North America, Inc.

TPG Global LLC

TransUnion

TriNet Group, Inc.

Tripadvisor

Truist Financial Corporation

Turner Construction Co.

Tyson Foods Inc.

U.S. Bank

Uber

UKG

UL Inc.

Under Armour Inc.

Unilever United States

Union Pacific

United Airlines

United Natural Foods, Inc.

United Parcel Service Inc.

Univar Solutions, Inc.

Constellation Energy Corporation

Constellations Brands Inc.

CONVERSE, Inc.

Core-Mark

CoreLogic

Corning Incorporated

Corteva Agriscience

Coty Inc.

Cox Enterprises Inc.

Credit Suisse USA Inc.

Crowell & Moring LLP

CSAA Insurance Group

Cue Health

Cummins Inc.

CVS Health

Dana-Farber Cancer Institute

Daniel J. Edelman Holdings, Inc.

Danone North America LLC

Darden Restaurants Inc.

Mattel, Inc.

McAfee LLC

McCormick & Company Inc.

McDonald's Corporation

McGraw Hill Education

McKesson

McKinsey & Company

McKinstry Co. LLC

Medline Industries, LP

Medtronic

Merck

Meredith Corp.

Meta

MetLife, Inc.

MGM Resorts International

Michael Page International Inc.

Micron

Microsoft

MillerKnoll Inc.

MolsonCoors

Universal Music Group

Univision Communications Inc.

Upwork

Vanguard Group Inc.

Verizon Communications Inc.

Vertex Pharmaceuticals Inc.

VF Corporation

ViiV Healthcare

Visa

Vizient Inc.

VMLY&R

VMware

W. W. Grainger, Inc.

Wabtec Corporation

Walt Disney Company, The

Warby Parker

Warner Music Group

Wawa, Inc.

WE Communications

Wellmark Blue Cross Blue Shield

Day Pitney LLP

Dayforce

Debevoise & Plimpton LLP

Del Monte Foods, Inc.

Dell Technologies

Deloitte LLP

Delta Air Lines Inc.

Deluxe Corporation

Denny's Corp.

Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.

Deutsche Bank USA Corp.

Diageo North America

Dickinson Wright PLLC

Diebold Nixdorf

Discover Financial Services

Domino's Pizza

DoorDash, Inc.

Dow Inc.

Doximity

Mondelez International

Moody's Corp.

Morgan Stanley

Morgan, Lewis & Bockius LLP

Morningstar Inc.

Morris Manning & Martin, LLP

Motive Inc.

Nasdaq Inc.

National Grid USA

Nationwide

Navient

Nestlé USA

Netflix Inc.

Neuberger Berman Group LLC

New Belgium Brewing

New York Life Insurance Company

NextRoll, Inc.

Nielsen

NIKE, Inc.

Wells Fargo

West Monroe Partners LLC

Western Digital

Whirlpool Corp.

Wiley

Williams-Sonoma Inc.

Wipro

Wise

Workday, Inc.

WPP

Wpromote

Wunderman Thompson

Wyndham Hotels & Resorts Inc.

Xcel Energy Inc.

Xerox Corp.

Xperi Holding Corporation

Xylem

Yelp Inc.

Yext

Zendesk

Dropbox Inc.

Duke Energy Corp.

Dun & Bradstreet Corp.

DWS Investments

Nordstrom, Inc.

Norfolk Southern Corporation

Northrop Grumman Corp.

Ziff Davis

Zillow Group

Zimmer Biomet Holdings Inc.

Zoetis Inc.

Zynga Games

Rating System and Methodology

Corporate Equality Index 2025

The HRC Foundation's CEI rating system is designed for mid- to large-sized businesses (500 full-time employees and above) and divided into three key categories of criteria:

- **Non-discrimination policies across business entities;**
- **Equitable benefits for LGBTQ+ workers and their families;**
- **Supporting an inclusive culture; and**
- **Corporate Social Responsibility.**

Launched in 2002, the CEI is the first internationally recognized benchmarking report for businesses to gauge their level of LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion against competitors. In addition to seeing a growth in the number of highly-rated employers, the CEI has also seen great success in the reach of the survey. **The number of employers officially rated has expanded from 319 original participants to a current participant count of 1449**, encompassing all major industry sectors.

Invitations and Participation

The largest and most successful U.S. employers are invited to participate in the CEI and are identified through the following lists*:

- **Fortune magazine's 1,000 largest publicly- and privately-traded businesses (2023 Fortune 1,000); and**
- **American Lawyer magazine's top 200 revenue-grossing law firms (2024 AmLaw 200).**

Additionally, any private-sector, for-profit employer with 500 or more full-time U.S. employees can request to participate, including those that are privately held.

**Note: Due to the staggered timelines of the ranking lists and when contact lists are made available, the ranking year lags the CEI survey year by one year and the CEI publication year by up to two years.*

How We Obtain Information

The primary source of information for the Corporate Equality Index rating each business received is the CEI survey sent every year to previous and prospective respondents. The web-based survey included links to sample policies and other guidance, found on the HRC Foundation website.

HRC Foundation staff provided additional assistance and direct consultation throughout the process and reviewed submitted documentation (required within each section) for appropriate language and consistency with survey answers.

Invitations for the CEI 2025 survey were emailed and mailed in April of 2024 and responses were returned in June 2024. If a business had previously participated in the

CEI, surveys were first sent to the individual(s) responsible for prior submissions. If a business had not previously participated in the CEI, surveys were sent to the chief executive officer or managing partner of the firm, as well as the highest-level executive(s) responsible for human resources, diversity, communications, or community engagement, if obtaining the contact information for these executives was possible.

Responsible Citizenship in the Corporate Equality Index

The information required to generate CEI ratings for businesses is difficult to ascertain from public records alone. In addition to the self-reporting provided through the CEI survey, we investigated and cross-checked the policies and practices of the rated businesses, connections with organizations that engage in anti-LGBTQ+ activities, and news accounts of efforts that undermine LGBTQ+ equality writ large (e.g., through case law efforts or public policy lobbying actions). To the greatest extent possible, these factors were reviewed before employers were rated. Businesses were invited to provide HRC Foundation staff with any additional information or updates before this report was released.

In total, the sources used include:

- **The HRC Foundation's CEI survey;**
- **Internal Revenue Service 990 tax filings reviewed for any business foundation's gifts to anti-LGBTQ+ groups;**
- **Case law and news accounts regarding findings of discrimination and corporate responsibility and the LGBTQ+ community-at-large; and,**
- **Individuals that report verifiable information to the HRC Foundation.**

Employers will receive anywhere from 5 to 25 points deductions for a large-scale official or public anti-LGBTQ+ blemish through Criterion 5: Responsible Citizenship. Scores in this criterion are based on information that has come to HRC's attention related to topics including but not limited to:

- advocating for public policies or regulations related to LGBTQ+ equality that would be detrimental to employees and their families.
- undue influence by a significant shareholder calculated to undermine a business's employment policies or practices related to its LGBTQ+ employees;
- opposing shareholder resolutions reasonably aimed at encouraging the adoption of inclusive workplace policies;
- revoking inclusive LGBTQ+ policies or practices;
- engaging in proven practices that are contrary to the business's written LGBTQ+ employment policies.
- directing corporate charitable contributions to organizations whose primary mission includes advocacy against LGBTQ+ equality;
- failing to uphold established commitments to the LGBTQ+ community resulting from pressure from anti-LGBTQ+ extremists

Responsible citizenship point deductions are effective for the current CEI cycle in which the infraction occurred plus one additional full survey cycle, unless the company responds to the LGBTQ+ community's concerns.

If at any time after losing points in this criterion an employer responds to the LGBTQ+ community's concerns, HRC will re-evaluate the point deduction for that employer. The rating change may not be reflected until the following year's Corporate Equality Index report, depending on the situation.

HRC will always seek to improve an organization's rating and seek resolutions to benefit an organization's LGBTQ+ workers, consumers and investors.

Official Ratings

To be officially rated in the CEI, businesses must have completed and submitted a CEI survey for review by the HRC Foundation's Workplace Equality Program team.

Additionally, the HRC Foundation may rate businesses that did not submit a survey for a 2025 rating if the business has submitted a survey in previous years and the information is determined to be accurate, or, if the HRC Foundation has obtained sufficient information to provide an individual rating. In both cases, the HRC Foundation notified the business of the official rating and gave them an opportunity to provide updates or clarification during the 2025 CEI survey cycle prior to the report release.

Unofficial Ratings

As has been the case for decades, Fortune 500-ranked businesses that, after multiple invitations, have never responded to the CEI survey were evaluated independently and have designated unofficial ratings listed in gray in Appendix A. The HRC Foundation proactively evaluates these **121** Fortune-ranked companies for two key reasons:

- **To provide the public with accurate information on these major employers; and,**
- **To ensure that the CEI is truly a benchmarking report among peers.**

Because LGBTQ+ workers and prospective employees must navigate the gaps in federal and state protections that affect their employment decisions, our staff researches these non-surveyed businesses through this same lens, ascertaining what we can from publicly available information and applying those findings to our CEI criteria.

No matter the rating, any business that participates in the CEI is taking on a transparent, credible process of LGBTQ+ inclusion. The HRC Foundation commends the employers that have committed to the public and transparent process of the CEI survey and we invite these **121** companies to do the same.

In total, the CEI 2025 contains official ratings for **376** Fortune 500 businesses, **534** Fortune 1000 businesses, **162** law firms and **752** additional major businesses. With the additional **121** Fortune 500 businesses that have unofficial ratings, the total number of rated businesses is **1,569**. Findings in the 2025 CEI report are based on the **1,449** officially rated businesses.

Scoring Criteria

Criteria 1

Workforce Protections (5 points possible)

Employment Non-Discrimination (5 points)

Businesses' employment non-discrimination policy must include the terms "sexual orientation" and "gender identity or expression" (or "gender identity") for all operations

Criteria 2

Inclusive Benefits (50 points possible)

To secure full credit for benefits criteria, each benefit must be available to all benefits-eligible U.S. employees. In areas where more than one health insurance plan is available, at least one inclusive plan must be available.

a. Equivalency in same- and different-sex spousal medical and soft benefits (10 points)

b. Equivalency in same- and different-sex domestic partner medical and soft benefits (10 points)

c. Equal health coverage for transgender individuals without exclusion for medically necessary care (25 points)

- Equal health coverage for transgender individuals without exclusions for medically necessary care
  - Insurance contract explicitly affirms coverage and contains no blanket exclusions for coverage
  - Insurance contract and/or policy documentation is based on the World Professional Association for Transgender Health (WPATH) Standards of Care
  - Plan documentation must be readily available to employees and must clearly communicate inclusive insurance options to employees and their eligible dependents.
  - Other benefits available for other medical conditions are also available to transgender individuals. Specifically, where available for employees, the following benefits should all extend to transgender individuals, including for transition-related services:
    - Short term medical leave
    - Mental health benefits
    - Pharmaceutical coverage (e.g., for hormone replacement therapies)
    - Coverage for medical visits or laboratory services
    - Coverage for reconstructive surgical procedures related to sex reassignment

d. LGBTQ+ Benefits Guide (5 points). Business must provide an LGBTQ+ inclusive benefits guide for its employees

Criteria 3

Supporting an Inclusive Culture & Corporate Social Responsibility (25 points possible)

a. LGBTQ+ Internal Training and Accountability (5 points)

Businesses must demonstrate a firm-wide, sustained and accountable commitment to diversity and cultural competency, including at least four of the following elements:

- New hire training clearly states that the nondiscrimination policy includes gender identity and sexual orientation and provides definitions or scenarios illustrating the policy for each
- Supervisors undergo training that includes gender identity and sexual orientation as discrete topics (may be part of a broader training), and provides definitions or scenarios illustrating the policy for each
- Integration of gender identity and sexual orientation in professional development, skills-based or other leadership training that includes elements of diversity and/or cultural competency
- Senior management/executive performance measures include LGBTQ+ diversity metrics
- Integration of intersectionality in professional development, skills-based, or other training (required for credit)

b. LGBTQ+ Data Collection (5 points)

Businesses must implement at least one of the following LGBTQ+ data collection efforts

- Anonymous employee engagement or climate surveys conducted on an annual or biennial basis allow employees the option to identify as LGBTQ+
- Data collection forms that include employee race, ethnicity, gender, military and disability status — typically recorded as part of employee records — include optional questions on sexual orientation and gender identity.
- Board (or other governing body) member demographic data collection include the option for individuals to report their sexual orientation and gender identity or self-identity as LGBTQ+

c. Transgender Inclusion Best Practices (5 points)

Businesses must have both of the following transgender inclusive best practices

- Gender transition guidelines with supportive restroom, dress code and documentation guidance
- Implementation of the at least one (1) of the following policies or practices
  - Trans-inclusive restroom/facilities policy
  - Gender-neutral dress code
  - Policies/procedures that allow for optional sharing of gender pronouns

d. Employee Group or Diversity Council (10 points)

Businesses must have either of the following:

- LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Group
- LGBTQ+ Diversity Council

Criteria 4

Corporate Social Responsibility (20 points possible)

a. Efforts of Outreach or Engagement to Broader LGBTQ+ Community (15 points)

Businesses must demonstrate ongoing LGBTQ+ specific engagement that extends across the firm, this includes at least five of the following:

- LGBTQ+ employee recruitment efforts with demonstrated reach of LGBTQ+ applicants (required documentation may include a short summary of the event or an estimation of the number of candidates reached)
- Supplier diversity program with demonstrated effort to include certified LGBTQ+ suppliers
- Marketing or advertising to LGBTQ+ consumers (e.g.: advertising with LGBTQ+ content, advertising in LGBTQ+ media or sponsoring LGBTQ+ organizations and events)
- Philanthropic support of at least one LGBTQ+ organization or event (e.g.: financial, in kind or pro bono support)
- Demonstrated public support for LGBTQ+ equality under the law through local, state or federal legislation or initiatives
- LGBTQ+ inclusive products and services

b. LGBTQ+ Corporate Social Responsibility (5 points)

Businesses must have both of the following:

- Contractor/supplier non-discrimination standards

- Philanthropic Giving Guidelines

Criteria 5

Responsible Citizenship (Up to 25 points)

Employers will receive up to 25 points deducted from their score for a large-scale official or public anti-LGBTQ+ blemish on their recent records. Scores on this criterion are based on information that has come to HRC's attention related to topics that are harmful to the advancement of LGBTQ+ equality and inclusion.

(See more information in the "Responsible Citizenship in the Corporate Equality Index" for more information)

CEI 2025 Maximum Score: 100 points

THE "EQUALITY 100 AWARD: LEADER IN LGBTQ+ WORKPLACE EQUALITY" DISTINCTION represents businesses' latest commitment to creating more equal and inclusive workplaces. Through its introduction with the CEI 2023-2024 survey, companies have worked more thoughtfully than ever to earn this recognition. HRC is proud to recognize the following **765** businesses that met all the criteria to earn a score of 100 and earn the new designation of being a 2025 "Equality 100 Award: Leader in LGBTQ+ Workplace Inclusion." Top-rated CEI

employers come from nearly every industry and region of the United States. To earn top ratings, these employers took concrete steps to establish and implement comprehensive policies, benefits and practices that ensure greater equity for LGBTQ workers and their families. We are honored to recognize the following companies:

A&O Shearman

Abbott Laboratories

AbbVie Inc.

Abercrombie & Fitch Co.

Accenture

Adidas North America Inc.

Adobe Inc.

ADUSA Distribution, LLC

ADUSA Transportation, LLC

Advance Auto Parts (Advance Holding)

Advanced Micro Devices Inc.

AECOM

The AES Corp.

Ahold Delhaize USA (ADUSA)

Air Products & Chemicals Inc.

Expedia Group

Experian North America

Extreme Networks

Factor Systems, LLC dba Billtrust

FactSet Research Systems Inc.

Faegre Drinker Biddle & Reath LLP

Farmers Insurance Group

Federal Home Loan Mortgage Corp. (Freddie Mac)

Federal National Mortgage Association (Fannie Mae)

Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston

Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago

Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland

Options Clearing Corporation

Oracle Corp.

Orrick, Herrington & Sutcliffe LLP

Oshkosh Corporation

Otis Worldwide Corporation

Pacific Investment Management Co. LLC

Panasonic Corporation of North America

Panera Bread Co.

Papa John's International Inc.

Paramount Global

Parsons Corporation

Paul Hastings LLP

PayPal Holdings Inc.

Pearson

Airbnb Inc.

Airbus Americas Inc.

Airlines Reporting Corporation (ARC)

Akin, Gump, Strauss, Hauer & Feld LLP

Alaska Airlines

Alcoa Corp.

Alcon Inc

Alight Solutions

AlixPartners LLP

AllianceBernstein LP

Alliant Energy Corp.

Allianz Life Insurance Co. of North America

Allstate Insurance Co.

Ally Financial Inc.

Alston & Bird LLP

Altice USA, Inc.

Altria Group Inc.

Amalgamated Bank

Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas

Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City

Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis

Federal Reserve Bank of New York

Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia

Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond

Federal Reserve Bank of St Louis

Fenwick & West LLP

Ferguson Enterprises

Ferrara Candy Company

Fidelity Investments

Fidelity National Information Services Inc.

Fifth Third Bancorp

First American Financial Corp.

Fiserv Inc.

Fish & Richardson PC

Peloton Interactive Inc.

PepsiCo Inc.

Perkins and Will Inc.

Perkins Coie LLP

Pernod Ricard USA LLC

PetSmart LLC

Pfizer Inc.

PGA TOUR, Inc.

Philip Morris International Inc.

Phillips 66

Pillsbury Winthrop Shaw Pittman LLP

Piper Sandler & Co.

Pitney Bowes Inc.

The PNC Financial Services Group Inc.

Point32Health, Inc.

Polsinelli

Portland General Electric Co.

PPG Industries Inc.

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP

Amazon.com Inc.

AMC Entertainment Inc.

AMC Networks

American Airlines

American Eagle Outfitters Inc.

American Express Company

American Greetings Corp.

Ameriprise Financial Inc.

Amgen Inc.

AMN Healthcare Services Inc.

Amtrak

Andersen Corporation

Anschutz Entertainment Group, Inc.

Aon plc

Apollo Global Management Inc.

Apple Inc.

Applied Materials Inc.

Aramark Corp.

Arcadis U.S. Inc.

Fisher & Phillips LLP

Fitch Group Inc

Fleishman-Hillard Inc.

Foley & Lardner LLP

Foley Hoag LLP

Food Lion LLC

Fortive Corp.

Franklin Templeton Investments

Fredrikson & Byron

Fresenius Medical Care AG

Fried, Frank, Harris, Shriver & Jacobson LLP

Frost Brown Todd LLP

Fujitsu America, Inc.

Gannett Co. Inc.

Gartner Inc.

GE Appliances

Gen Digital Inc.

Genentech Inc.

General Mills Inc.

Prime Therapeutics, LLC

Principal Financial Group

Privia Health LLC

Procter & Gamble Co.

Progyny, Inc.

Proskauer Rose LLP

Prudential Financial Inc.

Prysmian Cables and Systems USA, LLC

PTC Inc

Publicis Sapient

PVH Corp.

QIAGEN LLC

Quality Building Services Corp.

Quality Protection Services Inc.

Quarles & Brady LLP

Quest Diagnostics Inc.

Quickbase LLC.

Qurate Retail Group

R1 RCM Inc

Arch Capital Group Ltd

Arconic

Arctic Wolf Networks, Inc

Ares Management LLC

Armstrong Teasdale LLP

Arnold & Porter Kaye Scholer LLP

Arthur J. Gallagher & Co.

Arup US, Inc.

Ascena

ASML

Associated Banc-Corp

Assurant

Asurion LLC

AT&T Inc.

Atkore International Inc.

Autodesk Inc.

AvalonBay Communities Inc.

Avantor, Inc.

Avery Dennison

General Motors Co.

Genesco Inc.

Gensler

Gerson Lehrman Group Inc

Ghirardelli Chocolate Company

Giant Eagle Inc.

Giant of Maryland LLC

Gibson, Dunn & Crutcher LLP

Gilbane Building Company

Gilead Sciences Inc.

Global Payments Inc.

GlobalFoundries US Inc.

GODADDY Inc.

The Goldman Sachs Group Inc.

Goodwin Procter LLP

Google Inc.

Gordon Rees Scully Mansukhani, LLP

Goto Group, Inc.

Goulston & Storrs PC

Rackspace Technology

Radian Group Inc.

Ramboll US Corporation

Randstad

RAPID7

Raymond James Financial Inc.

RBC Wealth Management

Reckitt

Recreational Equipment Inc.

Red Ventures

Reed Smith LLP

Regeneron Pharmaceuticals

Reinhart Boerner Van Deuren s.c.

Relias LLC

RELX Inc.

Replacements Ltd.

Reynolds American Inc.

Riot Games Inc.

Rivian Automotive

Avita Care Solutions

AXA XL

Axiom Global Inc.

Bain & Co. Inc./ Bridgespan Group

Baker & Hostetler LLP

Baker & McKenzie LLP

Baker Botts LLP

Baker, Donelson, Bearman, Caldwell & Berkowitz PC

Ball Corp.

Ballard Spahr LLP

Bank of America Corp.

The Bank of New York Mellon Corp.

Barclays

Barilla America Inc.

BASF Corp.

Bass, Berry & Sims PLC

Bath & Body Works LLC

Battelle Memorial Institute

Government Employees Health Association, Inc.

Grant Thornton LLP

Grantham, Mayo, Van Otterloo & Co. (GMO) LLC

Great River Energy

Greenberg Traurig LLP

The Guardian Life Insurance Co. of America

Guess? Inc.

Guidehouse

H&R Block Inc.

Hannaford Supermarkets

The Hanover Insurance Group Inc.

The Hartford Financial Services Group Inc.

Health Care Service Corp.

The Hearst Corp.

Henkel Corporation

Henry Schein Inc.

The Hershey Co.

Robert W. Baird & Co. Incorporated

Robins Kaplan LLP

Roche Diagnostics Corp.

Rockland Trust Co.

Rockwell Automation Inc.

Rolls-Royce North America (USA) Holdings Co.

Ropes & Gray LLP

Ross Stores Inc.

RS Americas Inc.

RSM US LLP

RTX

S&P Global Inc.

S.C. Johnson & Son Inc.

Sabre Corporation

Salesforce

Sally Beauty Holdings Inc.

Samsung Electronics America Inc.

Sanofi

BAYADA Home Health Care

Bayer U.S. LLC

BDO USA, PC

Berkeley Research Group LLC

Berkshire Bank

Best Buy Co. Inc.

Biogen

BioMarin Pharmaceutical Inc.

BlackRock

Blackstone Inc.

Blank Rome LLP

Bloomberg LP

Blue Cross & Blue Shield of Rhode Island

Blue Cross Blue Shield Association

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Florida Inc.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Minnesota

Blue Cross Blue Shield of North Carolina

Hess Corp.

Hewlett Packard Enterprise Co.

Highmark Blue Cross Blue Shield Delaware

Highmark Inc.

Highmark West Virginia

HILTON

Hinshaw & Culbertson LLP

Hitachi Vantara

HKS INC.

Hogan Lovells US LLP

Holland & Hart LLP

Holland & Knight LLP

Honeywell International Inc.

Horizon Blue Cross Blue Shield of New Jersey

Horizon Media Inc.

Hormel Foods Corp.

HSBC USA

Humana Inc.

Huntington Bancshares Inc.

Santander US

SAP America Inc.

SAS Institute Inc.

Saul Ewing LLP

Savills Inc.

Schulte Roth & Zabel LLP

Scotiabank USA

Scotts Miracle-Gro Company

Seacoast National Bank

Seagate Technology plc

Securian Financial Group Inc.

Seismic Software, Inc.

Sephora

ServiceNow

Seyfarth Shaw LLP

Shake Shack Inc.

Shell USA, Inc.

Sheppard, Mullin, Richter & Hampton LLP

Shook, Hardy & Bacon LLP

Blue Cross Blue Shield Western New York

BMO Financial Corp.

BNP Paribas

BNSF Railway Company

Boeing Co.

Boies Schiller Flexner LLP

Boomi

Booz Allen Hamilton Inc.

Boston Consulting Group

Boston Scientific Corp.

Box Inc.

Braze, Inc.

Bread Financial Holdings, Inc.

Bridge Investment Group Holdings LLC

Brighthouse Financial, Inc.

Bristol Myers Squibb

Broadridge Financial Solutions Inc.

Brooks Running

Hunton Andrews Kurth LLP

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

Husch Blackwell LLP

Hyatt Hotels Corp.

Hyve Solutions Corporation

IBM Corp.

IGT

IHG Hotels & Resorts

IKEA Holding US Inc.

Illinois Tool Works Inc.

Illumina

Impossible Foods

Indeed Inc.

Informa PLC

Infosys Limited Inc.

Ingredion Inc.

Insight Enterprises Inc.

Instacart

Intel Corp.

Shure Incorporated

Shutterstock Inc.

Sidley Austin LLP

Siemens Medical Solutions USA Inc.

Signet Jewelers

Simpson Thacher & Bartlett LLP

Skadden, Arps, Slate, Meagher & Flom LLP

Skidmore, Owings & Merrill LLP

Slalom

Smartsheet

Smurfit WestRock

Société Générale

Sodexo Inc.

Softchoice Corporation

SONOS, INC.

Sony Interactive Entertainment LLC

Southern Co.

Southwest Airlines Co.

Brown Rudnick LLP

Brownstein Hyatt Farber Schreck LLP

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP

C&S Wholesale Grocers LLC

Cadence Design Systems

Cadwalader, Wickersham & Taft LLP

Caesars Entertainment Inc

Caleres

Cambridge Associates LLC

CannonDesign

Capgemini America, INC

The Capital Group Companies Inc.

The Capital Markets Company NV

Capital One Financial Corp.

Cardinal Health Inc.

CareFirst Inc.

CareSource

Interpublic Group of Companies Inc.

Intuit Inc.

Invesco Ltd.

Iron Mountain Inc.

J. M. Smucker Co.

Jackson Lewis PC

Jacobs Engineering Group Inc.

Janus Henderson Investors

Jenner & Block LLP

JLL

Johnson & Johnson

Johnson Controls Inc.

Johnson Financial Group

JPMorgan Chase & Co.

JSX

K&L Gates LLP

Katten Muchin Rosenman LLP

Kearney

Kellanova

Spencer Stuart

Spotify USA Inc.

Squire Patton Boggs

Standard Chartered

Standard Insurance Co.

Starbucks Corp.

State Street Corp.

Steelcase Inc.

Stellantis

Steptoe LLP

Stinson LLP

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation

Sun Life

Sunrun Inc.

Suntory Global Spirits

Surveymonkey Inc.

Sutherland Global Services Inc.

Sweetgreen, Inc.

Symbotic Inc.

Cargill Inc.

Cargo Transporters Inc.

CarGurus, Inc.

Carlson Inc.

The Carlyle Group LP

Carnival Corp.

Carrier Global Corporation

CBRE Inc.

Celanese Corp.

Cencora Inc.

Cengage Learning Inc.

Centene Corp.

CGI

Chapman and Cutler LLP

Charles Schwab & Co. Inc.

Chemonics International Inc

Chevron Corp.

Chipotle Mexican Grill Inc.

Choate, Hall & Stewart LLP

Chobani

Kelley Drye & Warren LLP

Keurig Dr Pepper Inc.

KeyCorp

Keysight Technologies

Kimberly-Clark Corp.

Kimco Realty Corp.

King & Spalding LLP

Kirkland & Ellis LLP

KKR & Co. LP

Kobre & Kim

Kohler Co.

Kohl's Corp.

Korn Ferry

KPMG LLP

The Kraft Heinz Company

Kramer Levin Naftalis & Frankel LLP

The Kroger Co.

Kutak Rock LLP

Lam Research Corp.

Synchrony

Syneos Health

Synopsys Inc.

SYSCO Corp.

T. Rowe Price Associates Inc.

Takeda Pharmaceuticals USA Inc.

Target Corp.

TD Bank, N.A.

TD Securities (USA) LLC

TD SYNNEX Corporation

TE Connectivity Inc.

TEGNA Inc.

Teradata Corp.

Terex Corp.

Teva Pharmaceuticals USA Inc.

Texas Instruments Incorporated

The Cigna Group

The Knot Worldwide

The Neiman Marcus Group Inc.

Choice Hotels International Inc.

Circana

Circle Internet Financial LLC

Cisco Systems Inc.

Citigroup Inc.

Citizens Financial Group

Cleary Gottlieb Steen & Hamilton LLP

The Clorox Co.

CME Group Inc.

CNA Financial Corporation

The Coca-Cola Company

Cognizant Technology Solutions Corp.

CohnReznick LLP

Colgate-Palmolive Co.

Colliers International Holdings (USA) Inc.

Comcast NBCUniversal

Comerica Inc.

Commonwealth Care Alliance

Land O'Lakes Inc.

Lane Powell PC

Latham & Watkins LLP

Lathrop GPM

Leidos Holdings

Leslie's, Inc.

Levi Strauss & Co.

Lexmark International Inc.

Liberty Mutual Insurance

Lincoln National Corp.

LinkedIn

Linklaters

Littler Mendelson PC

Lockheed Martin Corp.

Loeb & Loeb LLP

Lord, Abbett & Co. LLC

L'Oréal USA Inc.

Lowenstein Sandler LLP

LPL Financial Holdings Inc.

Lumen Technologies

The ODP Corporation

The Stop & Shop Supermarket Company, LLC

Thermo Fisher Scientific Inc.

Thompson Coburn LLP

Thompson Hine LLP

Thomson Reuters

T-Mobile USA Inc.

TowerBrook Capital Partners

TPG Global LLC

Transamerica Corp.

TransUnion

Travel + Leisure Co.

The Travelers Companies Inc.

TriNet USA, Inc.

Tripadvisor Inc.

Troutman Pepper Hamilton Sanders LLP

Truist Financial

TruStage

Turnberry Solutions Inc.

Commonwealth Equity Services, LLC dba Commonwealth Financial Network

Community Care Behavioral Health Organization

Conduent Incorporated

Constellation Energy Corporation

Cooley LLP

CooperCompanies

Cornerstone Research

Corning

Coty Inc.

Covington & Burling LLP

Cox Enterprises Inc.

Cozen O'Connor

Creative Artists Agency LLC

CrowdStrike Inc.

Crowe LLP

Crowell & Moring LLP

Cruise

Lumentum Operations LLC

LVMH North America

Lyft Inc.

Macmillan Learning

Macquarie Group Ltd.

Macy's Inc.

Mallinckrodt LLC

ManpowerGroup

Marathon Petroleum Corp.

Marriott International Inc.

Mars Inc.

Marsh & McLennan Companies Inc.

Massachusetts Mutual Life Insurance Co.

Mastercard

Mathematica Policy Research

Mattel Inc.

Mayer Brown LLP

McDermott Will & Emery LLP

McDonald's Corp.

U.S. Bancorp

Uber Technologies Inc.

UBS AG

UKG

UL Solutions

Unilever

Union Pacific Corp.

United Airlines Holdings, Inc.

United Launch Alliance

United Services Automobile Association

United States Steel Corp.

United Talent Agency, LLC

UnitedHealth Group Inc.

Univar Solutions Inc.

Unum Group

UPMC Health Plan

Urban Outfitters Inc.

UW Credit Union

Vanguard Group Inc.

CSAA Insurance Group

Cummins Inc.

Cushman & Wakefield

CVS Health Corp.

Daniel J. Edelman Inc.

Danone North America

Darden Restaurants Inc.

Davis Polk & Wardwell LLP

Day Pitney LLP

Dayforce

Debevoise & Plimpton LLP

Dechert LLP

Del Monte Foods, Inc.

Dell Technologies Inc.

Deloitte LLP

Deluxe Corp.

dentsu international

The Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.

Designer Brands

McGraw Hill LLC

McKesson Corp.

McKinsey & Co. Inc.

McKinstry Co. LLC

Medallia Inc.

Medline Industries, LP

Medtronic PLC

Meijer Inc.

MERGE

Mesirow Financial Holdings Inc.

Messer North America, Inc.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

MFS Investment Management

Michael Best & Friedrich LLP

Michael Page International Inc

Micron Technology Inc.

Microsoft Corp.

Milbank LLP

MillerKnoll

Verizon Communications Inc.

Vertex Pharmaceuticals Inc.

VF Corp.

Victoria's Secret & Co.

Visa

Vizient Inc.

Vontier Corporation

Vorys, Sater, Seymour and Pease LLP

Vox Media Inc.

Voya Financial

Vynamic LLC

W. L. Gore & Associates Inc.

W.W. Grainger Inc.

Wabtec Corporation

Walgreen Co.

Walker & Dunlop, LLC

The Walt Disney Company

Warby Parker

Warner Music Group

Deutsche Bank

Diageo North America

Dickinson Wright PLLC

Dick's Sporting Goods, Inc.

Discover Financial Services

Dollar Tree, Inc.

Domino's Pizza Inc.

DoorDash, Inc.

Dorsey & Whitney LLP

Dow

Doximity, Inc.

Dropbox Inc.

Duke Energy Corp.

The Dun & Bradstreet Corp.

Dupont de Nemours, Inc.

DWS Investment MGT Americas Inc

E&J Gallo Winery

EAB

Eastern Bank Corporation/Eastern

Mintz, Levin, Cohn, Ferris, Glovsky & Popeo PC

Moderna Inc.

Moody's Corp.

Moore & Van Allen PLLC

Morgan Stanley

Morgan, Lewis & Bockius LLP

Morningstar Inc.

Morris, Manning & Martin LLP

Morrison & Foerster LLP

Motorola Solutions Inc.

Munger, Tolles & Olson LLP

National Grid USA

NCR Voyix

Nestlé Health Science

Nestlé Purina PetCare Co.

Nestlé USA Inc.

NetApp Inc.

Neuberger Berman Group LLC

New Belgium Brewing Company

Waters Corp.

WE Communications

Weil, Gotshal & Manges LLP

Wells Fargo & Co.

The Wendy's Co.

West Monroe Partners LLC

Whirlpool Corp.

Wiley Rein LLP

Willamette Dental Group

William Blair & Company LLC

Williams Companies Inc.

Williams Mullen Clark & Dobbins

Willis Towers Watson

Willkie Farr & Gallagher LLP

Wilmer Cutler Pickering Hale & Dorr LLP

Wilson Sonsini Goodrich & Rosati PC

Winston & Strawn LLP

Wipfli LLP

Bankshares, Inc.

Eastman Chemical Co.

Eastman Kodak Co.

Eaton Corp.

eBay Inc.

Ecolab Inc.

Edward Jones

Egon Zehnder International Inc.

Electronic Arts Inc.

EMD Serono, MilliporeSigma and EMD Electronics

Empower

Enbridge

Engie Impact

Enterprise Mobility

Epic Systems Corporation

Equinix

Equitable

Ernst & Young LLP

The Estée Lauder Companies Inc.

New Relic Inc.

New York Life Insurance Company

Newfront Insurance Holdings, Inc.

Nielsen

Nike Inc.

Nixon Peabody LLP

Nomura

Nordstrom Inc.

Northern Trust Corp.

Northrop Grumman Corp.

Northwestern Mutual Life Insurance

Norton Rose Fulbright

Novartis Pharmaceuticals Corporation

Novo Nordisk Inc.

Numerator

NVIDIA Corp.

Oaktree Capital Management LP

Womble Bond Dickinson (US) LLP

Workday Inc.

Xcel Energy Inc.

Xerox Corp.

Xperi Inc.

Xylem Inc.

Yelp Inc.

Yum! Brands Inc.

Zebra Technologies Corporation

Zelis Healthcare, LLC

Ziff Davis

Zillow Group

Zimmer Biomet Holdings Inc.

Zoetis Inc.

ZS Associates Inc.

Zurich North America

Etsy Inc.

Eversheds Sutherland (US) LLP

Evolent Health Inc.

Exelon Corp.

Ogletree, Deakins, Nash, Smoak & Stewart

O'Melveny & Myers LLP

Omnicom Group

Appendix A: Employer Ratings

DOWNLOAD

CEI 2025 Employer Ratings

Download 2025 CEI Employer Ratings

To view employer score details, please visit www.hrc.org/cei/search.

The Human Rights Campaign Business Advisory Council was founded in 1997. Members provide expert advice and counsel to the HRC Workplace Equality Program on lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and queer workplace issues based on their business experience and knowledge.

Alex Rhodes, he/him (Business Council Co-Chair)
Global Diversity & Inclusion Executive and Enterprise LGBTQ+ Strategy Lead
Bank of America

Willard L. McCloud, III, he/him (Business Council Co-Chair)
Vice President - Diversity, Equity and Inclusion (DEI) and Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG)
Zimmer Biomet

Bob Witeck, he/him
President & Founder
Witeck Communications, Inc.

Corey Smith, he/him
Global Diversity, Equity & Inclusion
General Motors

Chris Mossiah, they/them
Executive Director, Employee Experience Digital Channels
JPMorganChase

Erik Day, he/him

John Barry, he/him
Vice President & Senior Relationship Manager, Global Funds Services
Northern Trust Corp.

Lanaya Irvin, she/her, they/them
Chief Executive Officer
Coqual

Michael Lopez, he/him
Senior Vice President, Inclusion, Diversity & Culture
HSBC

Michelle Phillips, she/her
Principal
Jackson Lewis P.C.

Mostafa Abdelguelil, he/him
Director, Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Programs
Adobe

Sean Mickens, he/him
Associate Vice President, External Affairs
Comcast

Senior Vice President, Global Inside Sales
Strategy & Transformation
Dell Technologies Inc.

About the Workplace Equality Program

The Workplace Equality Program at the Human Rights Campaign Foundation has been committed to equity and inclusion for LGBTQ+ workers since 1998.We have advanced LGBTQ+ equality by encouraging workplaces in the U.S. and beyond to adopt inclusive employment benefits, policies, and practices. By educating corporate entities and benchmarking corporate practices, we have motivated employers to adopt inclusive workplace benefits and protections that directly impact the lives of LGBTQ+ workers and their families.

As the premier national benchmarking tool, the Corporate Equality Index (CEI) is a primary driving force for LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion. This internal analysis allows companies to review key policies for inclusion in key areas. The CEI has worked with corporations to create workplaces where LGBTQ+ employees feel welcomed, affirmed, and can thrive.

Extending from the CEI, the Equidad/e Programs work to promote LGBTQ+ inclusion in Mexico, Chile, Argentina, and Brazil. These programs partner with local organizations to create culturally relevant standards for LGBTQ+ workplace inclusion, helping to build safer, more equitable environments for employees in these regions.

Additionally, our workplace training and climate research work offer a comprehensive suite of resources designed to help employers foster LGBTQ+ inclusive environments. Whether it is about the current state or the future needs of the LGBTQ+ workforce, these

resources help us identify emerging trends, gaps, and areas for future innovation, ensuring that our efforts remain aligned with the evolving needs of the LGBTQ+ community.

Together, these initiatives work towards creating workplaces where every LGBTQ+ person can feel safe, valued, and supported.